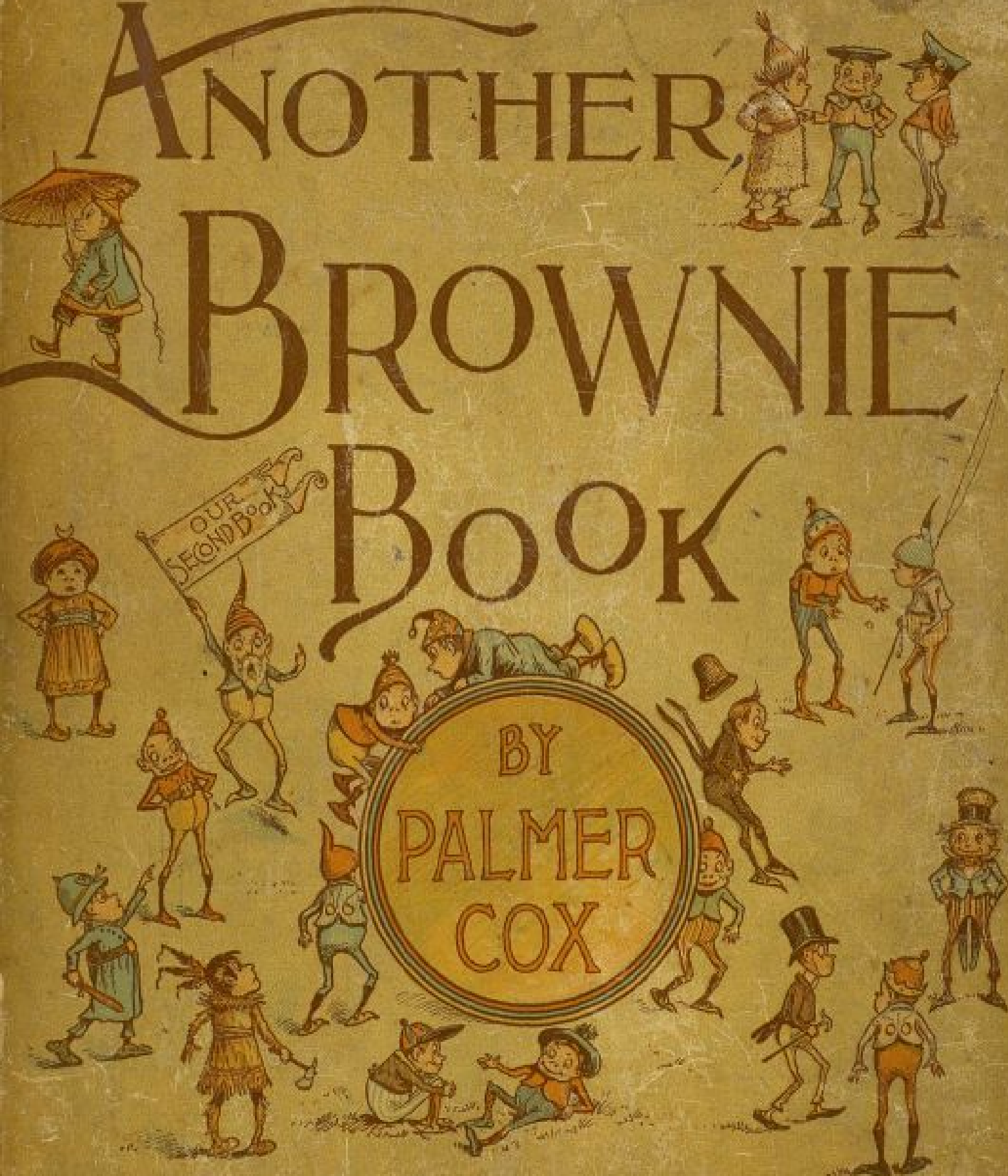
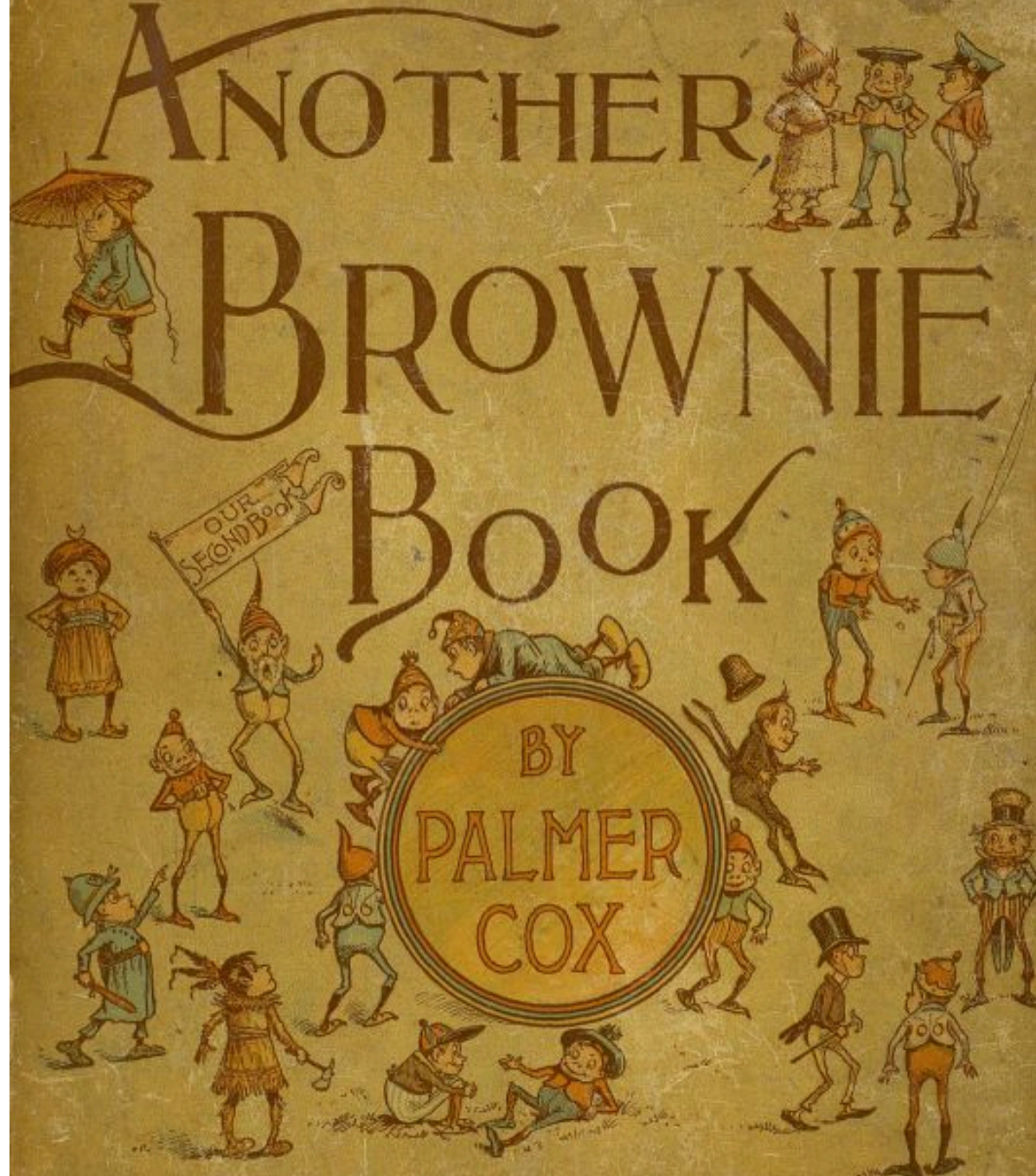


ANOTHER BROWNIE BOOK



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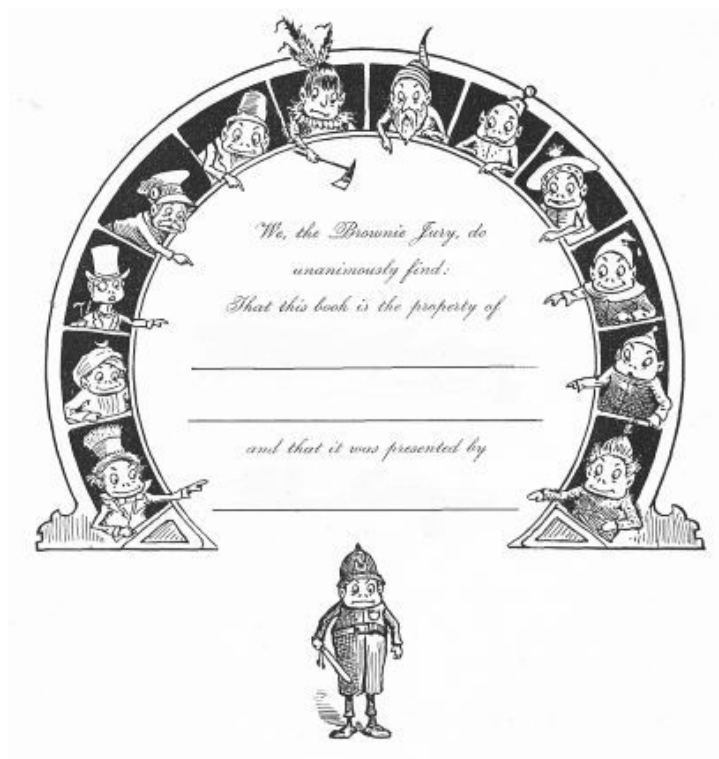
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BOOK ***



ANOTHER BROWNIE BOOK

BY
PALMER COX



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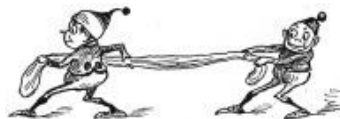
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THE BROWNIES' SNOW MAN.

When snowdrifts
 blocked the
 country roads,
 And trees were bending
 with their loads,
 The wind grew mild
 which had been
 raw,



And winter yielded to a thaw;
 That night the Brownies stood to stare
 In wonder on the village square.
 Said one, "This plot where drifts now roll
 Seems like an acre from the Pole.



I have a scheme which nothing
 lacks:
 Now while the snow so closely
 packs,
 And may be molded in the
 hand,
 We'll build a statue tall and
 grand



Which here shall stand at
morning prime,
To be the wonder of the time."
Another cried, "That suits us
all.

To work let
every
memb
er fall.

When once
the
task we undertake
Be sure no dwarfish man we'll
make;





But one that proudly may
look down
On half the buildings in the
town.

I know the place where
builders keep
Their benches while the
snow is deep;
The poles, and ladders too,
are there,

To use when
workin
g high
in air.



While some
for
these
with me will fly,
Let some their hands to snow
apply,
And not a feature of the man
Shall be neglected in our
plan.



"You know the night, some
time ago,
We tramped so far through
drifted snow
To ornament with quaint design
The windows of a mansion
fine;
And how, on lengthy ladders
there
And scaffold swinging in the
air,

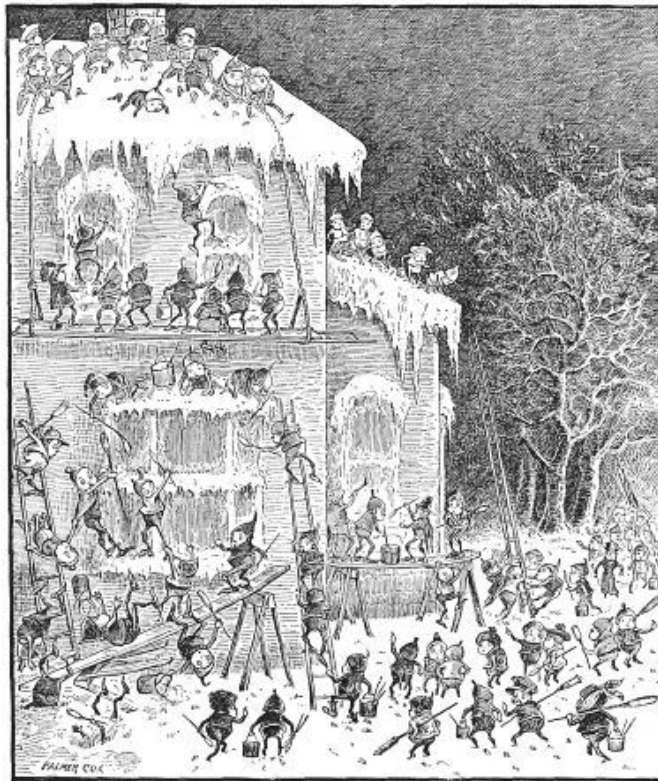
We worked our brushes with a
will
From icy cap to window-sill,
And made the people, great
and small,
Believe Jack Frost had done it
all?—



To-night we'll work as well, and show
A grand result before we go."

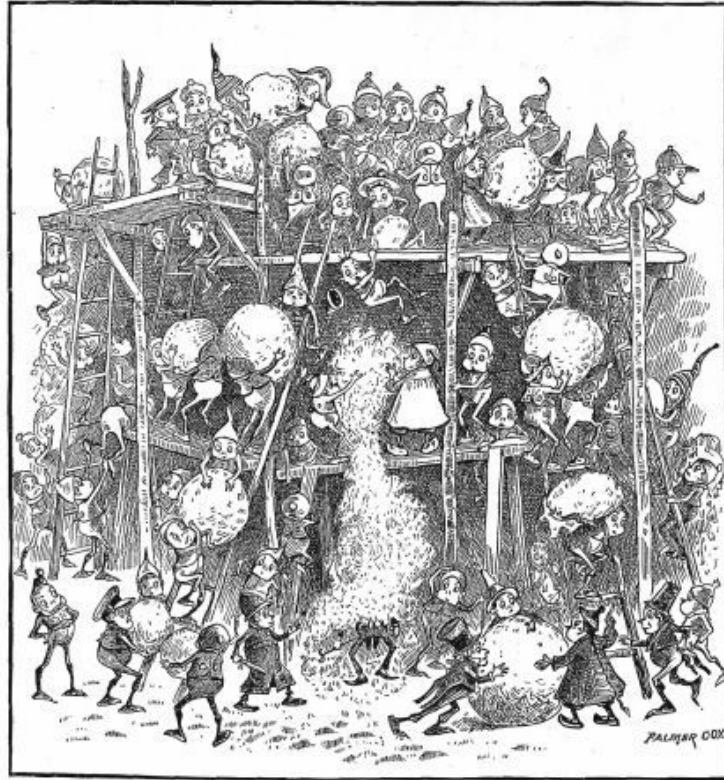


The snow that night was at
its best,
And held its shape
however pressed;
Like dough beneath the
baker's hand
It seemed to answer each
demand.
The rolls, when tumbled to
and fro,
Increased with every
turning, so



First like a cushion on they sped,
Then like a pillow, next, a bed,
Until the snow, adhering there,
Would leave the grass or pebbles bare.
As higher blocks of snow were laid
Still higher scaffolding was made,
And ladders brought to use instead
Of those too short to reach the head.

Thus grew the form from hour to hour;
 For Brownies' hands have wondrous power,
 And let them turn to what they will



Surprising work will follow still.
 Some shaped the legs or smoothed the waist,
 Some saw plump arms were rightly placed;
 The head was fixed with
 proper pose,
 Well fashioned were both ears
 and nose.



So close thronged Brownies
 high and low,
 A looker-on would hardly know
 What plan or shape the busy band
 Of cunning Brownies had in hand.



But plan they had, and deftness
 too,
 As well was seen when they
 were through.
 The rounded form and manly
 port
 Showed modeling of rarest sort,

While charcoal
eyes, so
well
designed



They seemed to
read the very mind,
Long icicles for beard and hair,
Were last affixed with taste and
care.

And when the poles around the
base

Had been returned each to its
place,

And every ladder, bench, and
board

They had in use, again was
stored,

The Brownies stood around
awhile

To gaze upon their work and
smile.

Each points at head, or hand, or
toe,

His special handiwork
to show.



In truth, they had good
reason there

With joy and pride to stand and stare,

And contemplate the object white

Which loomed above to such a height,

And not unlike some hero
old,

For courage famed, or action
bold,

With finger pointed out, as
though,

To indicate the coming foe.

But morning light soon came
to chase

The Brownies to their
hiding-place.

And children on their way to
school



Forgot their lessons and the
rule
While gazing on the statue tall
That seemed to guard the County Hall.
And after drifts had left the square,
When roads and shingle-roofs were bare,
The Brownies' statue, like a tower,
Still bravely faced both wind and shower—
Though sinking slowly all the while,
And losing corpulence and style,
Till gardeners, on the first of May,
With shovels pitched the man away.





THE BROWNIES IN THE ACADEMY.



The Brownies once with capers
spry
To an Academy drew nigh,
Which, founded by a generous
hand,
Spread light and learning
through the land.

The students, by ambition fired,
And men of science had retired;
So Brownies, through their mystic
power,

Now took advantage of the hour.

A battery was soon displayed,

And strange experiments were made;

Electric currents were applied

To meadow-frogs they

found inside,

Which sage professors,

nights and days,

Had gathered up, in

various ways.

To making pills some

turned the mind,

While some to Dentistry inclined,

And aching teeth, both small and large,

Were there extracted free of charge.



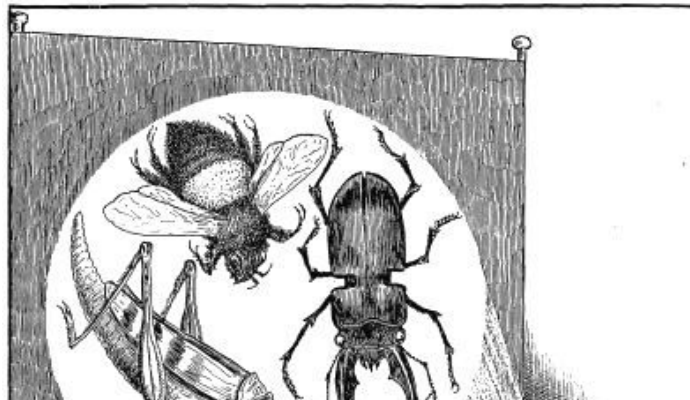


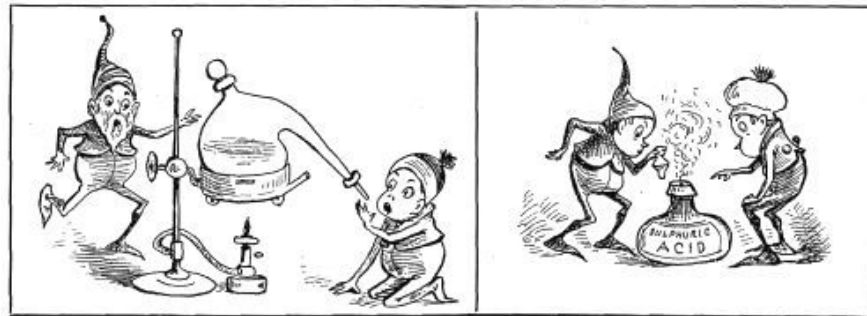
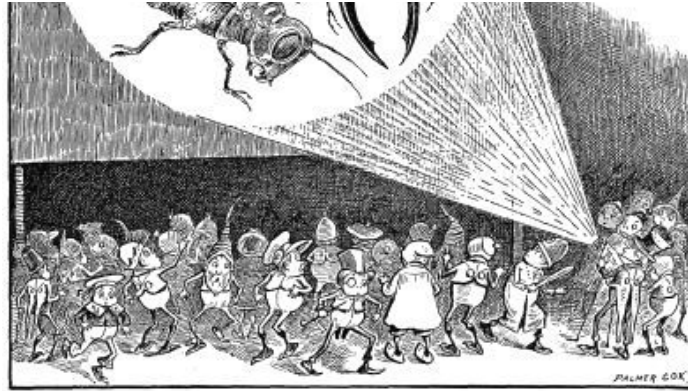
More gazed where phrenologic charts
 Showed heads partitioned off in parts.
 Said one: "Let others knowledge gain
 Through which to conquer ache and pain,
 But by these charts I'll do my best
 To learn where Fancy makes her nest."
 Another cried, as he surveyed
 The bumps that were so well arrayed:
 "These heads exhibit, full and clear,



Which one to love and whom to
 fear;
 Who is with noble thoughts
 inspired,
 And who with hate or envy
 fired;
 The man as timid as the hare,
 The man destructive as the
 bear.
 While choosing
 partners, one
 may find
 It well to keep these
 charts in
 mind."

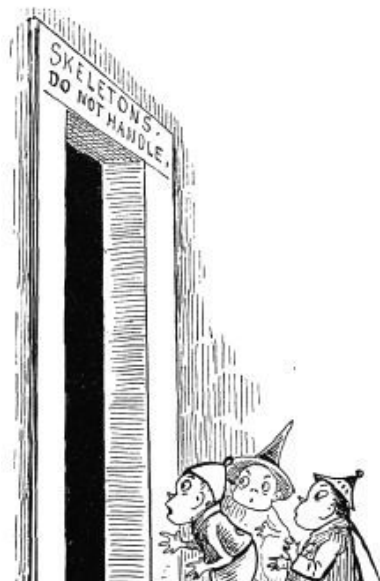
A microscope at length, they found;
 And next, the Brownies gathered
 round
 A stereopticon machine
 That cast its rays upon a screen.
 A thousand times it magnified,
 Till, stretching out on every side,





An object large and larger spread,
And filled the gazing group with dread.
The locust, beetle, and the bee
Soon gained proportions strange to see,
And seemed like monsters close at hand
To put an end to all the band.

Ere long a door
was open



swung,
To show some
skeletons
that hung
From hook and
peg, which
caused a
shout
Of fear to rise from
those about.
Said one: "Thus
Science
works its
way
Through old



though old
remains
from day to
day;

And those who
during life could find
No time, perhaps, to aid mankind,
May, after all, in some such place
For years assist the human
race
By giving students, as you
see,
Some knowledge of
Anatomy."
At other times, all breathless
grouped
O'er crucibles, the Brownies
stooped

To separate, with
greatest
skill,
The grains which
cure from
those that
kill;
While burning
acids,
blazes
blue,



And odors strong confused the crew.
Cried one: "Through trials hard to bear,
The student must himself prepare,
Though mixing paint, or mixing pill—
Or mixing phrases, if you will—
No careless study satisfies



If one would to distinction
rise;

The minds that shed
from pole to
pole

The light of years, as
round we roll,
Are first enriched
through
patient toil,
And kindled by the
midnight oil."

Thus,



spicing
logic with a
joke,
They chatted on till
morning

morning
broke;
And then with wild
and rapid race
The Brownie band
forsook the
place.



THE BROWNIES IN THE ORCHARD.



HE autumn nights began to fill
The mind with thoughts of winter
chill,
When Brownies in an orchard met,
Where ripened fruit was hanging
yet.

Said one, "The apples here, indeed,
Must now be mellow
to the seed;
And, ere another
night, should
be



Removed at once from every tree.
For any evening now may call
The frost to nip and ruin all."
Another quickly answer made:
"This man is scarcely worthy aid;
'Tis said his harsh and cruel sway



Has turned his children's love
away.

"If this be true, 't would serve
him right"

If frost should paint his orchard
white."

"It matters not who owns the
place,

Or why neglect thus shows its
face,"

A third replied; "the fact is clear
That fruit should hang no
longer here.

If worthy people here reside
Then will our hands be well
applied;

And if unworthy folks we
serve,

Still better notice we'll
deserve."

"You





 speak our minds so full and
 fair,"

 One loudly cried, "that speech we'll spare.
 But like the buttons on your back,
 We'll follow closely in your track,
And do our part with willing hand,
Without one doubting *if* or *and*."
Kind deeds the Brownies often do
 Unknown to me as well as you;
 The wounded hare, by hunters maimed,
 Is sheltered and supplied and tamed.

 The straying cat they
 sometimes find
 Half-starved, and chased by
 dogs unkind,



 And bring it home from many
 fears
 To those who mourned its loss
 with tears.
 And to the bird so young and
 bare,



 With wings unfit to fan the air,
 That preying owls had thought
 to rend

The Brownie often proves a
friend.
Then bags and baskets were
brought out
From barns and buildings round
about,
With kettles, pans, and wooden-
ware,
That prying eyes discovered
there;
Nay, even blankets from the
beds,
The pillow-slips, and table-
spreads
Were in some manner brought
to light
To render service through the
night.

If there's a place where
Brownies feel
At home with either hand or
heel,



And seem from all restrictions
free,
That place is in a branching
tree.

At times, with balance fair and
fine

They held their stations in a
line;

At times, in rivalry and pride
To outer twigs they scattered
wide;

And oft with one united strain
They shook the tree with might
and main,



Till, swaying wildly to and fro,
It rocked upon the roots below.
So skilled at climbing were they all
The sum of accidents was small:
Some hats were crushed, some heads were sore,
Some backs were blue, ere work was o'er;



For hands will slip and feet will
slide,

And boughs will break and forks
divide,

And hours that promise sport
sublime

May introduce a limping time.

So some who clambered up the tree
With ready use of hand and knee,
Found other ways they could
descend

Than by the trunk, you may depend.

The startled birds of night came

out

And watched them as they
moved about;



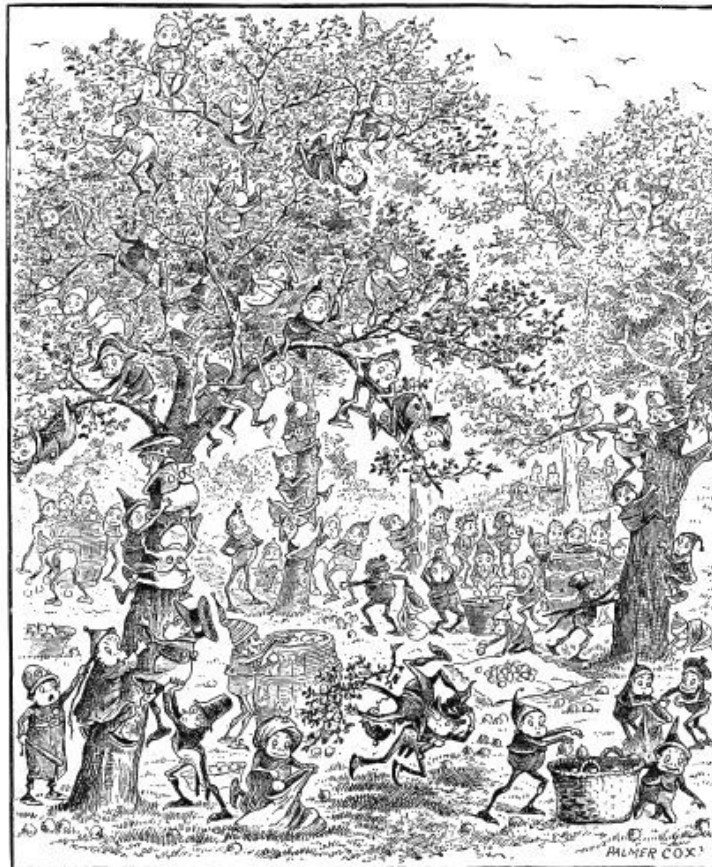
Concluding thieves were out in
force
They cawed around the place till
hoarse.



But birds, like people, should be slow
To judge before the facts they know;



For neither tramps nor
thieves were here,
But Brownies, honest and
sincere,
Who worked like mad to
strip the trees
Before they felt the
morning breeze.
And well they gauged
their task and time,
For ere the sun
commenced to
prime



The sky with faintest tinge of red
The Brownies from the orchard fled,

While all the fruit was laid with care
Beyond the reach of nipping air.

THE

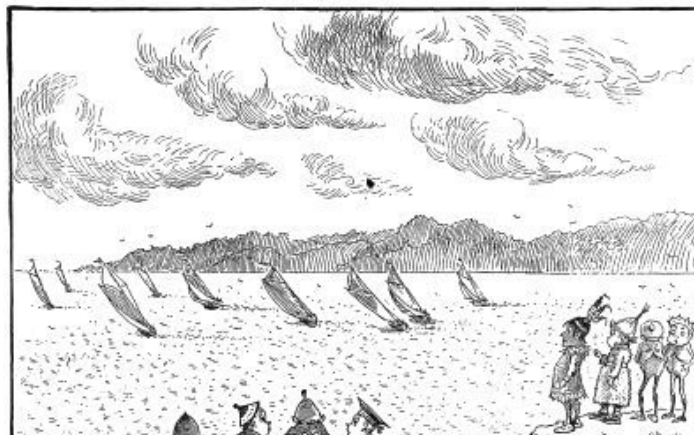
BROWNIES'



YACHT-RACE.



WHEN fleets of yachts were sailing
round
The rippling bay and ruffled
sound,
And steering out where Neptune
raves,
To try their speed in rougher
waves,
The Brownies from a lofty place
Looked out upon the novel race.
Said one: "A race is under way.
They'll start from somewhere in
the bay,
To leave the frowning forts
behind,
And Jersey headlands, as you'll
find,
And sail around, as I surmise,
The light-ship that at anchor lies.
All sails are spread, the masts will
bend,
For some rich prize they now
contend—
A golden cup or goblet fine,
Or punch-bowl of antique
design."
Another said: "To-night, when all
Have left the boats, we'll make a
call,
And boldly sail a yacht or two
Around that ship, as people do.





If I can read the signs aright
That nature shows 'twill be a night
When sails will stretch before the
blast,
And not hang idly round the
mast."



So thus they talked, and plans
they laid,
And waited for the evening shade.
And when the

lamps in
city
square
And narrow
street
began to
glare,
The Brownies
ventured
from their
place
To find the
yachts
and sail
their race.

In equal numbers
now the
band,
Divided up, the
vessels
manned.
Short time they



...
wasted in
debate
Who should be captain, cook, or
mate;

But it was settled at the start
That all would take an active part,
And be prepared to pull and haul
If trouble came in shape of squall.
For in the cunning Brownie crowd
No domineering is allowed;
All stand alike with equal power,
And friendly feeling rules the
hour.

The Brownies' prophecy was true.
That night the wind increased and
blew,
And dipped the sails into the
wave,

And work to every Brownie gave;
Not one on board but had
to clew,

Or reef, or steer, or
something do.

Sometimes the yachts ran
side by side

A mile or more, then
parted wide,

Still tacking round and
shifting sail

To take advantage of the
gale.





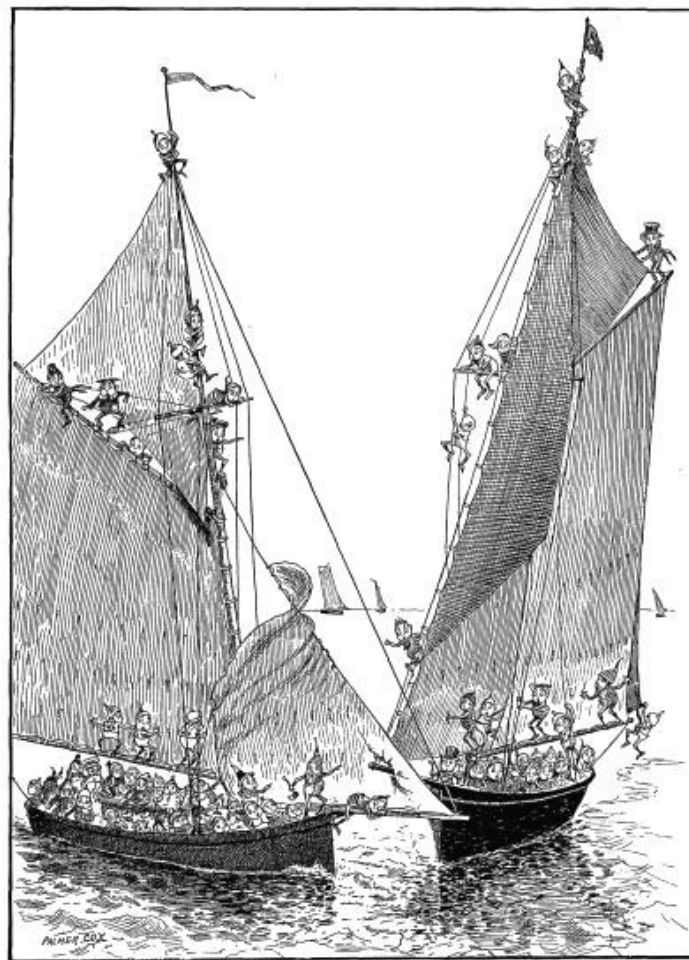
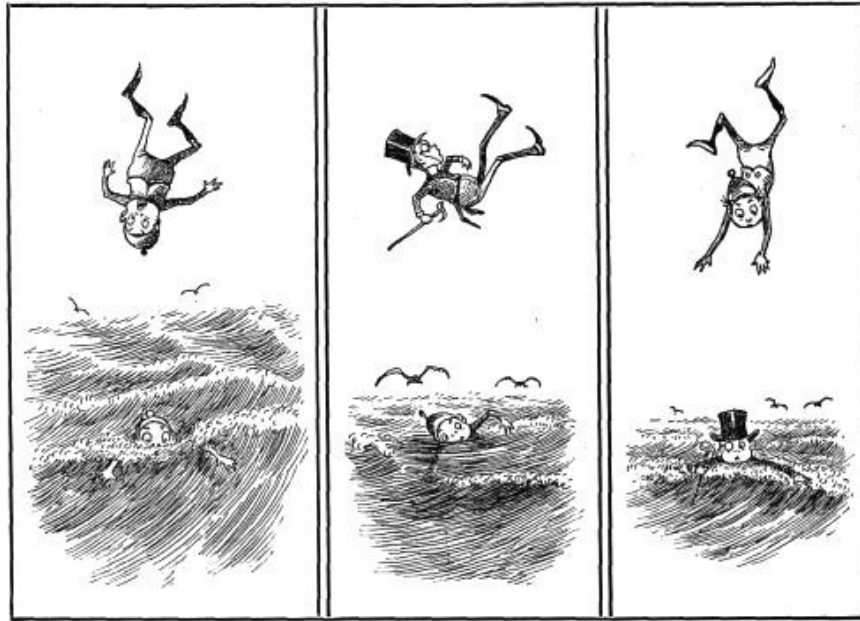
Sometimes a sloop beyond
control
At random ran, or punched a
hole
Clean through her scudding
rival's jibs,
Or thumped her soundly on the
ribs.

Of Brownies
there
were two
or three

Who tumbled
headlong
in the
sea,



While they performed some
action bold,
And failed to keep a proper
hold.
At first it seemed they would be
lost;
For here and there they pitched
and tossed,
Now on the crests of billows
white,
Now in the trough, clear out of
sight,
But all the while with valiant
heart
Performing miracles of art.





Some life-preservers soon were thrown;
 And ready hands let sails alone,
 And turned to render aid with speed
 To those who stood so much in need.
 But accident could not displace
 Or weaken interest in the race;
 And soon each active Brownie stood
 Where he could do the greatest good;
 It mattered not if shifting sail,
 Or at the helm, or on the rail.
 With arm to arm and hip to hip,
 They lay in rows to trim the ship.



hands were anxious to succeed
 And prove their yachts had greatest speed.
 But though we sail, or though we ride,
 Or though we sleep, the moments glide;
 And none must bear this fact in mind
 More constantly than Brownie kind.
 For stars began to lose their glow
 While Brownies still had miles to go.
 Said one, who scanned the eastern sky
 With doubtless an experienced
 eye:
 "We'll crowd all sail, for fear the
 day
 Will find us still upon the bay—
 Since it would prove a sad affair
 If morning light should find us

if morning light should find us
there."



But



when the
winds
began to
fail
And lightly pressed
the flapping
sail,
It was determined
by the band
To run their yachts
to nearest
land,
So they could
reach their
hiding-
place
Before the sun
revealed his
face.



By happy chance a
cove they
reached
Where high and
dry the
boats were
beached,
And all in safety
made their
way
To secret haunts
without
delay.





THE BROWNIES AT ARCHERY.



One night the Brownies strayed
 around
 A green and level stretch of
 ground,
 Where young folk oft their skill
 displayed
 At archery, till evening's shade.
 The targets standing in the park,
 With arrows resting in the mark,



Soon showed the cunning Brownie band
 The skill of those who'd tried a hand.



A few in outer rings were fast,
 Some pierced the "gold," and
 more had passed
 Without a touch, until they sank
 In trunk of tree or grassy bank.
 Said one: "On page and
 parchment old,
 The story often has been
 told,
 How men of valor bent
 the bow
 To spread confusion
 through the foe.
 And even now, in later times



And even now, in later times
(As travelers find in distant
climes),



Some savage tribes on plain and hill
Can make it interesting still."

Another spoke: "A scene like this,
Reminds me of that valiant Swiss,
Who in the dark and trying hour
Revealed such nerve and matchless power,

And from the head of his brave
son

The apple shot, and freedom won!
While such a chance is offered
here,

We'll find the bows that must be
near,

And as an hour or two of night
Will bring us 'round the morning
light,

We'll take such targets as we may,
To safer



haunts, some
miles away.

Then at our leisure
we can shoot

At bull's-eyes round
or luscious
fruit,

Till like the Swiss of
olden time,

With steady nerves
and skill
sublime,

Each one can split an

Each one can spit an
apple fair
On every head that
offers there."
Now buildings that were fastened
tight
Against the prowlers of the night,



At the wee Brownies' touch and
call
Soon opened and surrendered all.
So some with bulky targets strode,
That made for eight or ten a load.
And called for engineering
skill
To steer them up or down
the hill;
Some carried bows of
rarest kind,
That reached before and
trailed behind.
The English "self-yew" bow was there,
Of nicest make and "cast" so rare,
Well tipped with horn, the proper thing,
With "nocks " or notches for the string



With rocks, or notches, for the string.
Still others formed an "arrow line"
That bristled like the porcupine.



When safe within the forest shade,
The targets often were displayed.
At first, however near they stood,
Some scattered trouble through the wood.
The trees were stripped of leaves and bark,
With arrows searching for the mark.
The hares to other groves withdrew,
And frightened birds in circles flew.
But practice soon improves the art
Of all, however dull or smart;



And there they
stood to do
their best,
And let all other
pleasures
rest,
While quickly
grew their
skill and
power,
And confidence,
from hour
to hour.
When targets
seemed too
plain or
wide,
A smaller mark the
Brownies
tried.
By turns each
member
took his
stand
And risked his

head to
serve the
band.



For volunteers would bravely
hold
A pumpkin till in halves it
rolled;
And then a turnip, quince, or
pear,
Would next be shot to pieces
there;

Till not



alone the
apples
flew
In halves before
their
arrows
true,

But even plums and cherries
too.

For Brownies, as we often find,
Can soon excel the human kind,
And carry off with effort slight
The highest praise and honors
bright.



THE BROWNIES FISHING.



HEN glassy lakes and streams about
Gave up their bass and speckled
trout,
The Brownies stood by water
clear
As shades of evening gathered
near.





Said one: "Now
country
lads begin
To trim the rod and
bend the
pin
To catch the frogs
and
minnows
spry
That in the brooks
and ditches
lie.
While city chaps
with reels
come
down,
And line enough to
gird the
town,
And flies of
stranger
shape and
hue
Than ever Mother
Nature
knew—
With horns like
crickets,
tails like
mice,
And plumes like
birds of
Paradise.
Thus well prepared
for sunny
sky

Or cloudy weather, wet or dry,
They take the fish from stream and pool
By native art and printed rule."
Another said: "With peeping eyes
I've watched an angler fighting flies.

And thought, when thus he stood to bear
The torture from those pests of air,
There must indeed be pleasure fine
Behind the baited hook and line.

Now, off like arrows from the bow
In search of tackle some must go;
While others stay to dig
supplies

Of bait that anglers
highly prize,—
Such kind as best will
bring the pout
The dace, the chub, and
'shiner' out;

While locusts gathered
from the grass

Will answer well for thorny bass."

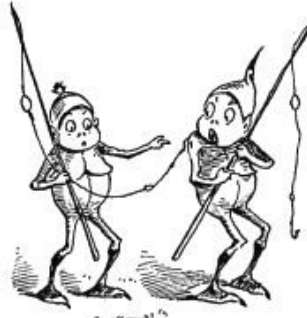
Then some with speed for tackle start,
And some to sandy banks depart,
And some uplift a stone or rail
In search of cricket, grub, or snail;



While more in dewy meadows draw
The drowsy locust from the straw.
Nor is it long before the band
Stands ready for the sport in hand.
It seemed the time of all the year
When fish the starving stage were near:

They rose to straws and bits of bark,
To bubbles bright and shadows dark,

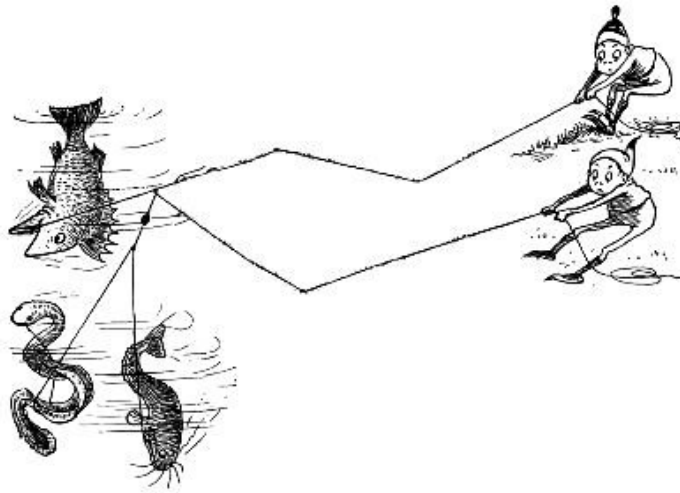
And jumped at hooks, concealed or bare,
 While yet they dangled in the air.
 Some Brownies many trials met
 Almost before their lines were wet;
 For stones below would hold them fast,
 And limbs above would
 stop the cast,
 And hands be forced to
 take a rest,
 At times when fish were
 biting best.
 Some stumbled in above
 their boots,
 And others spoiled their
 finest suits;
 But fun went on; for many there
 Had hooks that seemed a charm to bear,
 And fish of various scale and fin
 On every side were gathered in.



The catfish left his bed below,
 With croaks and protests from
 the go;



And nerve as well as time it
took
From such a maw to win the
hook.
With horns that pointed every
way,
And life that seemed to stick
and stay,
Like antlered stag that stands at
bay,
He lay and eyed the Brownie
band,
And threatened every reaching
hand.



The gamy bass, when playing
fine,
Oft tried the strength of hook
and line,
And strove an hour before his
mind
To changing quarters was
resigned.
Some eels proved more than
even match
For those who made the
wondrous catch,
And, like a fortune won with
ease,
They slipped through fingers by
degrees,

.

And bade good-bye to margin
sands,
In spite of half a dozen hands.
The hungry, wakeful birds of
air
Soon gathered 'round to claim
their share,
And did for days themselves
regale

On fish of every stripe
and scale.
Thus sport went on with
laugh and shout,
As hooks went in and
fish came out,
While more escaped
with wounded
gill,
And yards of line they're trailing still;
But day at length began to break,
And forced the Brownies from the lake.



THE BROWNIES AT NIAGARA FALLS.



THE Brownies' Band, while passing
through
The country with some scheme in
view,
Paused in their race, and well they
might,
When broad Niagara came in sight.
Said one: "Give ear to what I say,
I've been a traveler in my day;
I've waded through Canadian mud
To Montmorenci's tumbling flood.
But ah! Niagara is the fall
That truly overtops them all—
The children prattle of its tide,
And age repeats its name with pride
The school-boy draws it on his slate,
The preacher owns its moral weight;
The tourist views it dumb with awe,
The Indian paints it for his squaw,
And tells how many a warrior true
Went o'er it in his bark canoe,
And never after friend or foe
Got sight of man or boat below."
Another said: "The Brownie Band
Upon the trembling brink may stand,



Where kings and queens have
sighed to be,
But dare not risk themselves at
sea."

Some played along the shelving
ledge
That beetled o'er
the river's
edge;
Some gazed in
meditation
deep



Upon the water's fearful leap;
Some went below, to crawl about
Behind the fall, that shooting out

Left space where they might
safely stand
And view the scene so wild and
grand.
Some climbed the trees of cedar
kind,
That o'er the rushing stream
inclined,



To find a seat, to swing and frisk
And bend the boughs at fearful risk;
Until the rogues could dip and lave
Their toes at times beneath the wave.

Still more and
more would
venture out



In spite of every
warning shout.
At last the weight that dangled
there
Was greater than the tree could
bear.



And then the snapping roots let
go
Their hold upon the rocks
below,
And leaping out away it rode
Upon the stream with all its
load!

Then shouts
that
rose
abo
ve
the
roar



Went up from tree-top, and
from shore,
When it was thought that half
the load

the band
Was now forever leaving land.
It chanced, for reasons of their
own,

Some

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And stretching fifty feet along.
Before it disappeared from sight,
The Brownies seized it in their might,
And then a strain for half an hour
Went on between the mystic power
Of Brownie hands united all,
And water rushing o'er the fall.
But true to friends the
Brownies strained,
And inch by inch the tree was gained.
Across the awful bend it passed
With those in danger clinging fast,
And soon it reached the rocky shore



With all the Brownies safe once more.
And then, as morning showed her face,
The Brownies hastened from the place.



THE BROWNIES' GARDEN.



NE night, as spring began to
show
In buds above and blades
below,
The Brownies reached a
garden square
That seemed in need of
proper care.
Said one, "Neglected
ground like this
Must argue some one most
remiss,
Or beds and paths would
here be found
Instead of rubbish
scattered round.
Old staves, and boots, and
woolen strings,
With bottles, bones, and
wire-springs,

Are quite unsightly things to
see
Where tender plants should
sprouting be.
This work must be
progressing soon,
If blossoms are to smile in
June."

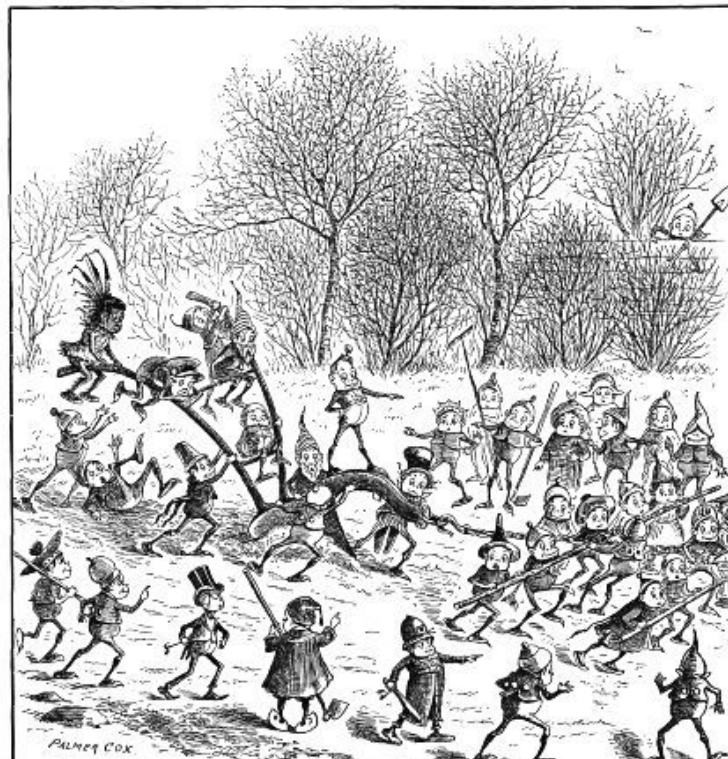


A second said, "Let all give heed:
On me depend to find the seed.
For, thanks to my foreseeing mind,
To merchants' goods we're not confined.
Last autumn, when the leaves grew sere
And birds sought regions less severe,





One night through gardens
fair I sped,
And gathered seeds from
every bed;
Then placed them in a
hollow tree,
Where still they rest. So
trust to me
To bring supplies, while
you prepare
The mellow garden-soil
with care."



Another cried, "While
some one goes
To find the shovels, rakes,
and hoes,
That in the sheds are
stowed away,
We'll use this plow as best
we may.
Our arms, united at the
chain,
Will not be exercised in
vain,
But, as if colts were in the
trace,

We'll make it dance around the
place.
I know how deep the share
should go,
And how the sods to
overthrow.

So not a patch of ground the size
Of this old cap, when flat it lies,
But shall attentive care receive,



And be improved
before we
leave."
Then some to
guide the
plow
began,
Others the walks
and beds to
plan.
And soon they
gazed with
anxious
eyes
For those who ran
for seed-
supplies.
But, when they
came, one

had his say,
And thus explained
the long
delay:
"A woodchuck in
the tree had
made
His



bed just
where the
seeds were
laid.
We wasted half an
hour at
least
In striving to
dislodge the
beast;
Until at length he turned
around,
Then, quick as thought,
without a sound,
And ere he had his bearings
got,
The rogue was half across
the lot."

Then seed was sown in various styles,
In circles, squares, and single files;
While here and there, in central parts,
They fashioned diamonds, stars, and hearts,
Some using rake, some plying hoe,
Some making holes where seed should go;
While some laid garden tools

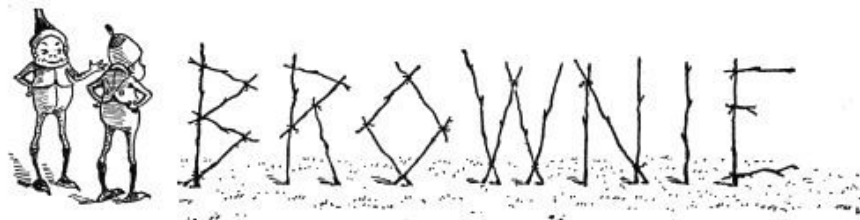


aside
And to the soil their hands
applied.
To stakes and racks more
were assigned,
That climbing-vines support
might find.
Cried one, "Here, side by
side, will stand
The fairest flowers in the
land.
The thrifty bees for miles
around
Ere long will seek this plot of
ground,
And be



surprised to find each
morn
New blossoms do each bed
adorn.
And in their own peculiar
screed
Will bless the hands that
sowed the seed."
And while that night they
labored there,
The cunning rogues had
taken care
With sticks and strings to
nicely frame
In line the letters of their
name.
That when came round the
proper time
For plants to leaf and vines
to climb,
The Brownies would
remembered be

remembered be,
If people there had eyes to
see.
But morning broke (as break
it will
Though one's awake or
sleeping still),
And then the seeds on every
side
The hurried Brownies
scattered wide.



Along the road and through
the lane
They pattered on the ground
like rain,
Where Brownies, as away
they flew,
Both right and left full



handfuls threw,
And children often halted
there
To pick the blossoms, sweet
and fair,
That sprung like daisies from
the mead
Where fleeing Brownies
flung the seed.

THE BROWNIES' CELEBRATION.



NE night the Brownies reached a
mound

That rose above the country
round.

Said one, as seated on the place
He glanced about with
thoughtful face:

"If almanacs have matters right
The Fourth begins at twelve to-
night,—



A fitting time
for us
to fill

Yon cannon
there
and
shake
the
hill,



And make the people all about
Think war again has broken
out.

I know where powder may be
found

Both by the keg and by the
pound;

Men use it in a tunnel near



For blasting purposes, I hear.
To get supplies all hands will
go,
And when we come we'll not be
slow
To teach the folks the proper
way
To honor Independence Day."

It was not long till powder
came.
Then from the muzzle broke the
flame,
And echo answered to the
sound
That startled folk for miles
around.
'Twas lucky for the Brownies'
Band
They were not of the mortal
brand,
Or half the crew would have
been hurled
In pieces to another world.
For when at last the cannon
roared,
So huge the charge had
Brownies poured,
The metal of the gun rebelled
And threw all ways the load it
held.
The pieces clipped the daisy-
heads
And tore the tree-tops into
shreds.

But Brownies are not slow to
spy
A danger, as are you and I.



For they through strange and mystic
art
Observed it as it flew apart,
And ducked and dodged and
flattened out,
To shun the fragments flung about.
Some rogues were lifted from their
feet

And, turning
somersa
ults
complet
e,



Like leaves

went twirling through the air

But only to receive a scare;

And ere the smoke away had cleared

In forest shade they disappeared.

THE BROWNIES IN THE
SWIMMING-SCHOOL.



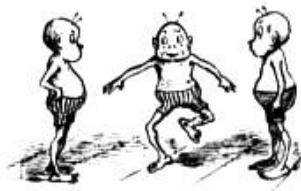
HILE Brownies passed
along the street,
Commenting on the
summer's heat
That wrapped the city day
and night,
A swimming-bath
appeared in sight.
Said one: "Of all the sights
we've found,
Since we

co
mm
enc
ed
to
ram
ble round,



This seems to better suit
the band

Than anything, however grand.
We'll rest awhile and find our way
Inside the place without delay,
And those who understand the art,
Can knowledge to the rest impart;



For every one should
able be,
To swim, in river,
lake, or sea.
We never know how
soon we may,
See





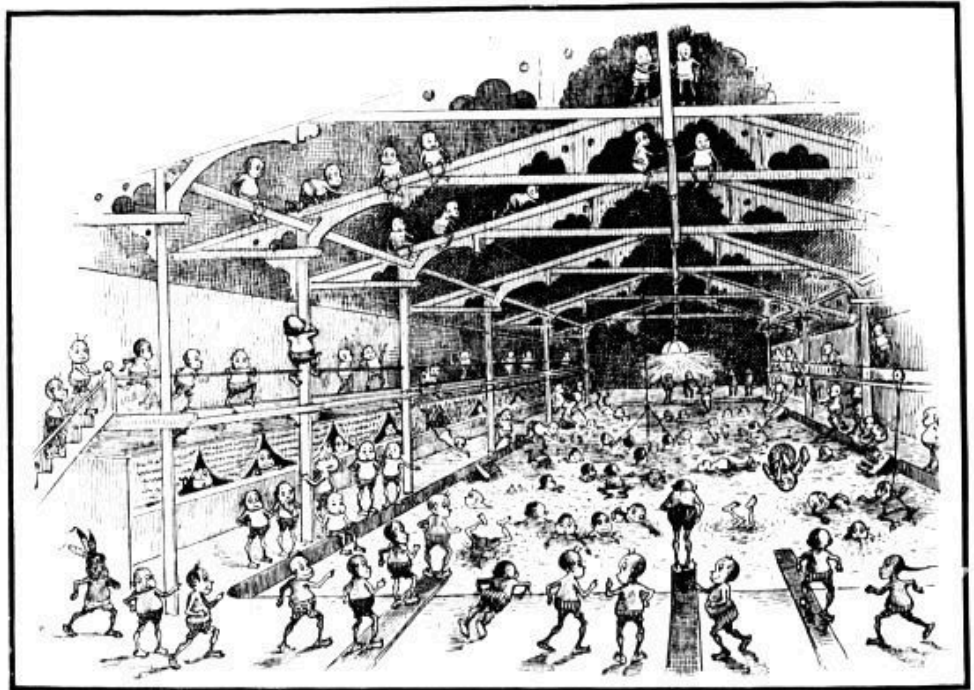
some one
sinking in
dismay,—
And then, to have the
power to save
A comrade from a
watery grave,
Will be a blessing
sure to give
Us joy the longest
day we live."

The doors soon opened through the power
That lay in Brownie hands that hour.
When once within the fun began,
As here and there they quickly ran;
Some up the stairs made haste to go,
Some into dressing-rooms below,
In bathing-trunks to reappear
And plunge into the water clear;
Some from the spring-board leaping fair
Would turn a somersault in air;
More to the bottom like a stone,
Would sink as soon as left alone,
While others after trial brief
Could float as buoyant as a leaf.



Some all their time to
others gave
Assisting them to ride
the wave,
Explaining how to
catch the
trick,
Both how to strike
and how to
kick;
And still keep nose
above the tide,
That limos with air

that range with all
might be
supplied.



Thus diving in and
climbing out,
Or splashing round with
laugh and shout,
The happy band in water
played
As long as Night her
scepter swayed.
They heard the clocks in
chapel towers
Proclaim the swiftly
passing hours.
But when the sun looked
from his bed
To tint the eastern sky with
red,
In haste the frightened
Brownies threw
Their clothes about them
and withdrew.





THE BROWNIES
AND THE WHALE.





S Brownies chanced at eve to stray
Around a wide but shallow bay,
Not far from shore, to their surprise,
They saw a whale of monstrous size,
That, favored by the wind and
tide,
Had ventured in from
ocean wide,
But waves receding by-
and-by,
Soon left him with a
scant supply.



At times, with flaps and lunges
strong
He worked his way some yards
along,
Till on a bar or sandy marge
He grounded like a leaden barge.
"A chance like this for all the
band,"
Cried one, "but
seldom
comes to
hand.



I know the bottom
of this bay
Like those who
made the coast survey.
'Tis level as a threshing-floor
And shallow now from shore to
shore;
That creature's back will be as dry



As hay beneath a tropic sky,
Till morning tide comes full and free
And gives him aid to reach the sea."

"I catch the hint!" another cried;
"Let all make haste to gain his side
Then clamber up as best we may,
And ride him round till break of
day."



At once, the band in great
delight
Went splashing through
the water bright,
And soon to where he
rolled about
They lightly swam, or
waded out.

Now climbing up, the
Brownies tried

To take
posi
tion
for
the
ride.



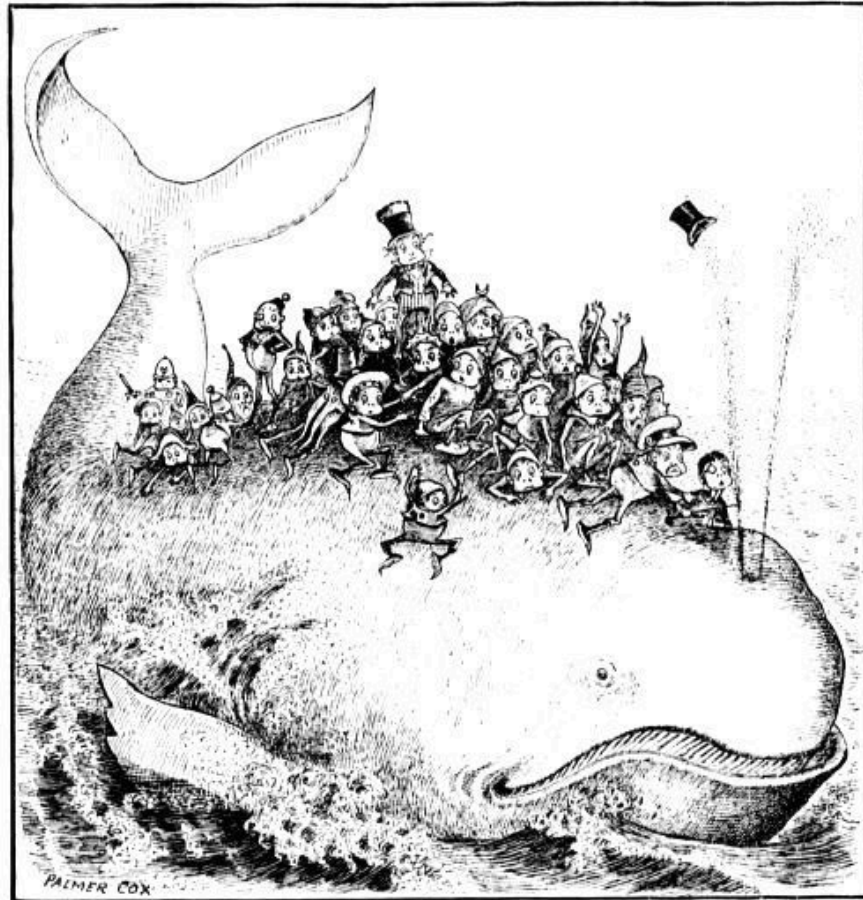
Some lying down a hold
maintained;

More, losing place as soon as
gained,
Were forced a dozen times to
scale



21

The broad side of the stranded
whale.
Now half-afloat and half-aground
The burdened monster circled
round,



Still groping clumsily about
As if to find the channel out,
And Brownies clustered close, in
fear
That darker moments might be
near.
And soon the dullest in the band
Was sharp enough to understand
The creature was no longer
beached,
But deeper water now had
reached.
For plunging left, or plunging

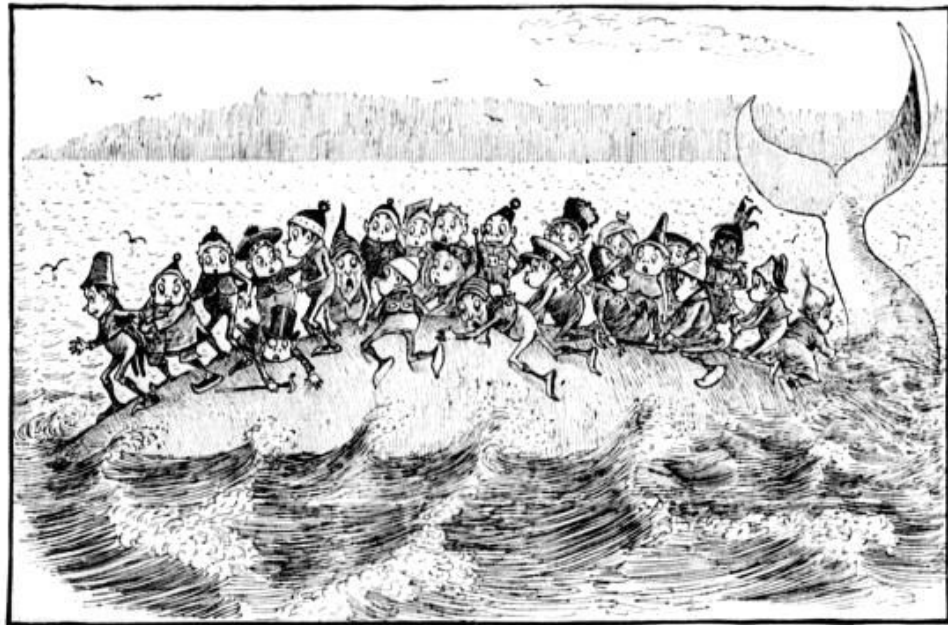
right,
Or plowing downward in his
might,
The fact was plain, as plain could
be—
The whale was working out to
sea!

A creeping fear will seize the
mind
As one is leaving shores behind,
And knows the bark whereon he
sails
Is hardly fit to weather gales.
Soon Fancy, with a graphic
sweep,
Portrays the nightmares of the
deep;
While they can see, with living
eye,
The terrors of the air sweep by.



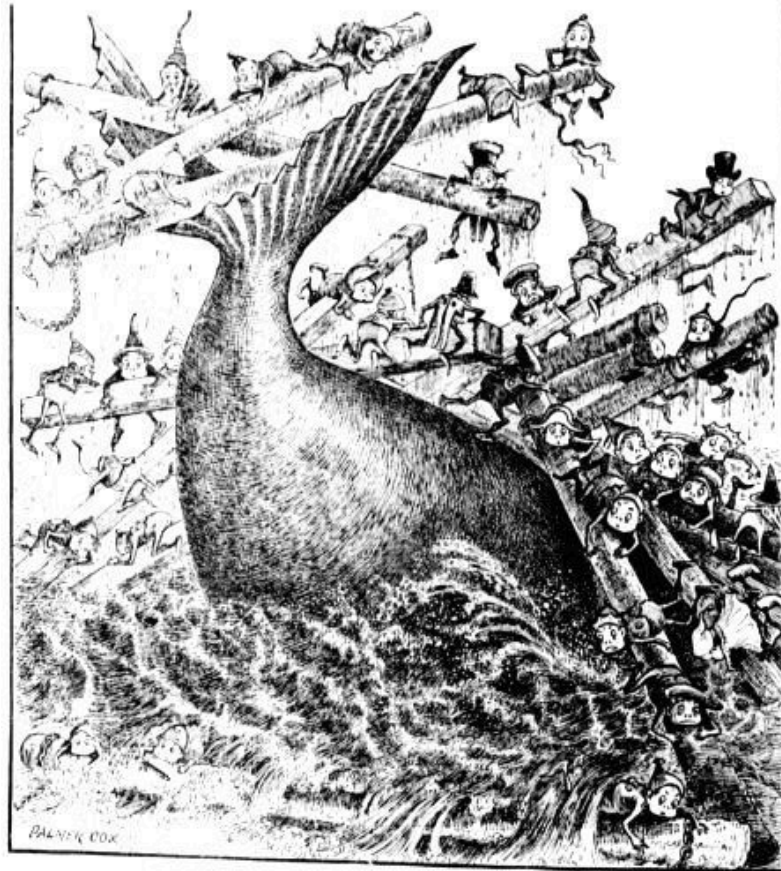
For who would not a
fierce bird dread,
If it came flying at his
head?
And these were hungry,
squawking
things,
With open beaks and
flapping wings.
They made the
Brownies dodge
and dip,
Into the sea they feared
to slip.
The birds they viewed
with chattering
teeth,
Yet dreaded more the
foes beneath.
The lobster, with his ready claw;
The fish with sword, the fish with

saw;
The hermit-crab, in coral hall,
Averse to every social call;
The father-lasher, and the shrimp,
The cuttle-fish, or ocean imp,
All these increase the landsman's
fright,
As shores are fading out of sight.
Such fear soon gained complete
command
Of every Brownie in the band.
They looked behind, where fair
and green
The grassy banks and woods were
seen.
They looked ahead, where white
and cold
The foaming waves of ocean
rolled,
And then, with woful faces drew
Comparisons between the two.



Some blamed themselves for
action rash
Against all reason still to dash
In danger's way, and never think

Until they stood on ruin's brink.
While others threw the blame on
those
Who did the risky trip propose.
But meantime deep and deeper
still
The whale was settling down until
His back looked like an island
small
That scarce gave standing-room to
all.
But, when their chance seemed
slight indeed
To sport again o'er dewy mead,
The spouting whale, with
movement strong,
Ran crashing through some
timbers long
That lumbermen had strongly tied
In cribs and rafts, an acre wide.





'Twas then, in such a trying hour,
 The Brownies showed their nerve
 and power.
 The diving whale gave little time
 For them to choose a stick to
 climb,—
 But grips were strong; no hold
 was lost,
 However high the logs were
 tossed;
 By happy chance the boom
 remained
 That to the nearest shore was
 chained,
 And o'er that bridge the Brownies
 made
 A safe retreat to forest shade.





THE BROWNIES' KITES.

The



sun had hardly taken flight
Unto the deepest caves of night;
Or fowls secured a place of rest
Where Reynard's paw could not molest,
When Brownies gathered to pursue
Their plans regarding pleasures new.
Said one: "In spite of hand or string,
Now hats fly round like crows in spring,
Exposing heads to gusts of air,

That ill the
 slightest
 draught
 can bear;
While, high
 above the
 tallest
 tower,



At morning,
 noon, and evening hour,
The youngsters' kites with streaming
 tails
Are riding out the strongest gales.
The doves in steeples hide away
 Or keep their houses through the
 day,
Mistaking every kite that flies
For bird of prey of wondrous
 size."

"You're not alone," another cried,
"In taking note. I, too, have spied
The boys of late, in street and
 court,

Or on the roofs, at this fine sport;
But yesternight I chanced to see
A kite entangled in a tree.

The string was nowhere to be
 found;

The tail about a bough was
 wound.

Some birds had torn the paper out,
To line their nests, in trees about,
But there beside the wreck I staid,
Until I learned how kites are
 made.

On me you safely may depend,
To show the way to cut and bend.
So let us now, while winds are
 high,

Our hands at once to work apply;
And from the hill that lifts its

crown
So far above the neighboring
town,

We'll send

our
kite
s
alof
t in

crowds,

To lose themselves among
the clouds."

A smile on every face was
spread,

At thought of fun like this,
ahead;

And quickly all the plans
were laid,

And work for every
Brownie made.

Some to the kitchens ran
in haste,

To

ma
nuf
act
ure
pot
s of paste.

Some ran for tacks or
shingle-nails,

And some for rags to make
the tails,

While more with loads of
paper came,

Or whittled sticks to make
the frame.

The strings, that others
gathered, soon

Seemed long enough to
reach the moon.

But where such quantities
they found



they found,
'Tis not



so easy to
expound;—
Perhaps some twine-
shop, standing
nigh,
Was raided for the large
supply;
Perhaps some youthful
angler whines
About his missing
fishing-lines.



But let them find things where they will,
The Brownies must be furnished still;
And those who can't such losses stand,
Will have to charge it to the Band.
With busy fingers, well applied,
They clipped and pasted, bent and tied;
With paint and brush some ran about
From kite to kite, to fit them out.
On some they paint a visage fair,
While others would affright a bear,

Nor was it long (as one might guess
Who knows what skill their hands
possess)
Before the kites with string and tail

Before the kites, with string and tail,
Were all prepared to ride the gale;
And oh, the climax of their glee
Was reached when kites were floating
free!

So quick they mounted through the air
That tangling strings played mischief
there,



And threatened to remove from land
Some valued members of the band.

The birds of night were horrified
At finding kites on every side,
And netted strings, that seemed to be
Designed to limit action free.

But



~~Brownies stood or ran about,~~



Now winding up, now letting out;
Now giving kites more tail or
wing,
Now wishing for a longer string;
Until they saw the hints of day
Approaching through the morning
gray.



THE BROWNIES' DANCING- SCHOOL.



WHEN flitting bats commenced to wheel
Around the eaves to find their meal,
And owls to hoot in forests wide,
To call their owlets to their side,
The Brownie Band, in full array,
Through silent streets pursued their way.
But as they neared a building high,
Surprise was shown in every eye.
They heard the strains of music sweet,
And tripping of the dancers' feet;
While o'er the tap of heel and toe,
The twang of harp and scrape of bow,
Arose the clear and ringing call
Of those who had control of all.
The Brownies slackened their swift pace,
Then gathered closely round the place,





To study out some way to win
A peep or two at those within.
Said one: "In matters of this kind
Opinions differ, you will find.
And some might say, with sober
thought,
That children should not thus be
taught
To hop around on toe and heel
So actively to fiddle's squeal,
For fear 'twould turn their
minds away
From graver duties of the day."
Another said: "The dancing art
Doth ease to every move
impart.
It gives alike to city-bred
And country-born a graceful
tread,
And helps them bear themselves
along
Without offense in greatest throng.



The nimble step, the springing knee,
And balanced body all
agree.
The feet, my friends, may
glide with grace
As well as trudge from
place to place.
And in the parlor or
without
They best can stand or
walk about
Who found in early life a chance
To mingle in the sprightly dance."
The Brownies need no ladders long,
No hoists, nor elevators strong,
To lift them to an upper flight,
A window sill or transom light



A window-sill, of unalloyed light.
The weather-vane upon the spire,
That overlooks the town entire,
Is not too high above the base
If fancy leads them to the place.
'Tis said the very fleecy clouds
They can bestride in eager crowds,

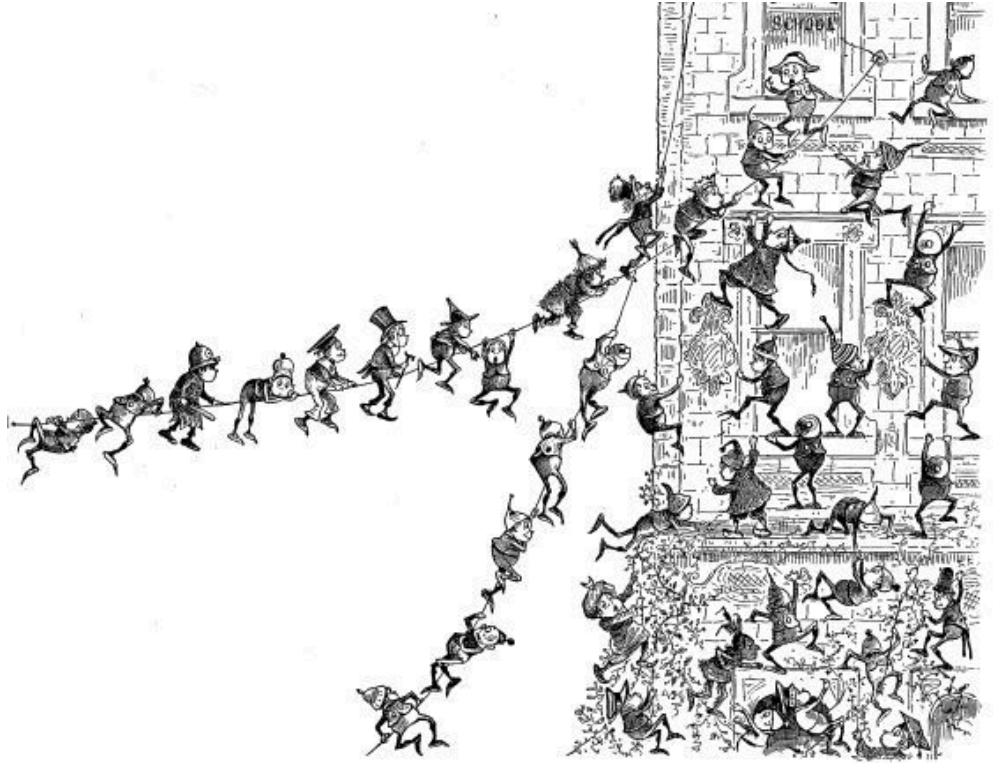


Around the world their way to find,
And leave the lagging winds behind.
Said one: "We've scaled the dizzy heights
Of mountain-peaks on other nights,
And crossed the stream from shore to shore
Where but the string-piece stretched before;
And cunning Brownies, never fear,
Will find some way to enter here."



HEN once the Brownies'
plans were laid,
No formal, tiresome
speech was made.
In mystic ways, to
Brownies known,
They clambered up the
walls of stone.
They clung to this and
that, like briers,
They climbed the smooth
electric wires;
Some members lending
ready aid
To those who weaker
nerves displayed.
And in five minutes at the
most,
By vine, by bracket, and
by post,
By every scroll, and
carving bold,
That toes could touch or
fingers hold
They made their way, and
gained a chance
To view, unnoticed, every
dance.
Said one: "How pleasant is
the sight
To see those children
young and bright
While skipping blithely to
and fro,
Now joined in pairs, now
in a row,
Or formed in circles, hand
in hand,
And lightly moving at
command—





Like butterflies through balmy air
 When summer spreads attractions fair,
 And blends with every whispering
 breeze
 The drowsy hum of working bees."



Another said: "When this is o'er
 The Brownie Band will take the floor.
 We'll bide our time and not
 be slow



To take possession when they go.
 Then up and down the spacious
 hall
 We'll imitate the steps of all.
 We'll show that not in
 Frenchmen's bones
 Lies all the grace that nature
 owns;
 That others at the waltz can
 shine
 As well as Germans from the
 Rhine;
 That we some capers can enjoy
 As well as natives of Savoy."

AS WELL AS NATIVES OF SAVOY.

While thus they talked, the
moments flew,
And soon the master's task was
through.

When children's cloaks were wrapped
around,

And heavier shoes
their feet had
found

They hastened home;
but while they
slept



The Brownies in that
building crept

To take their turn at lively reel,

At graceful glide, or dizzy wheel,
Till all the dances people know,

From Cuba's palms to Russia's
snow

Were tried, and soon in every
case

Were mastered with surprising
grace.

Imagine how they skipped
about,

And how they danced, with
laugh and shout!





o sooner had the Brownies run
Into the hall than 'twas begun.
Some round the harp, with
cunning stroke,
The music in the strings awoke.
The violins to others fell,
Who scraped, and sawed, and
fingered well,
Until the sweet and stirring air
Would rouse the feet of dullest
there.
Like people in the spring of life,
Of joys and countless blessings
rife,
Who yield themselves to
Pleasure's hand—
So danced that night the Brownie
Band.
First one would take his place to
show
The special step for heel or toe,
Just how to edge about with care,
And help around the partner fair,
Nor plant his feet upon a dress—
To cause confusion and distress.
Then more would play the
master's part,
And give some lessons in the art:



Would show the rest some figures
new
From Turkey, China, or Peru.



Now smoothly glide, as if on
wings,
Then bob around, as if on springs,
Until the sprightly steps would
call
Loud acclamations from them all.
They danced in twos with skip
and bound,
They danced in circles, round and
round;
They danced in lines that coiled
about
As runs the serpent in and out,
Some moving slow, some
standing still—
More cutting capers with a will.
At length, by joining hand in
hand,
The set included all the band.
A happier crowd was never seen
On ball-room floor or village
green.
By turns they danced, by turns
would go
And try their skill at string and
bow—
They almost sawed the fiddle
through

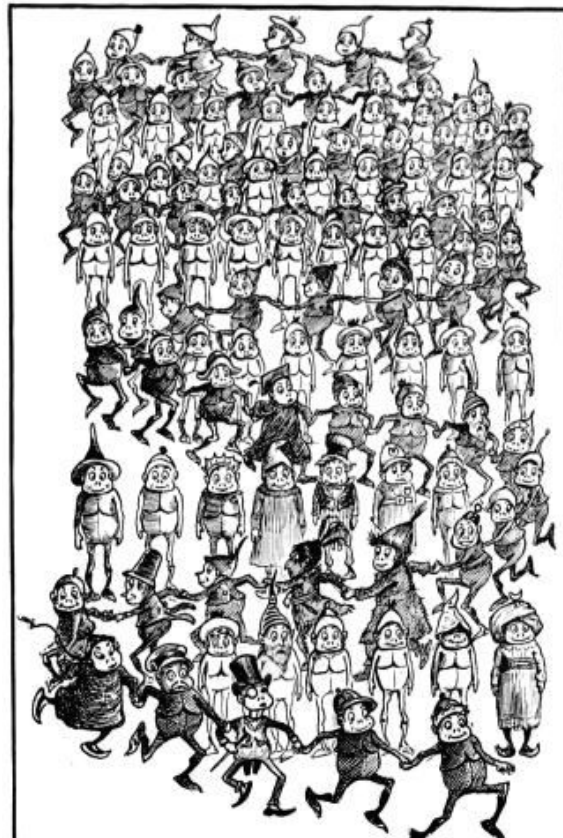


 enough,
So fast the bow across it flew.
And louder still the harp would
 ring,
As nimbler fingers plucked the
 string.
Alike they seemed a skillful band
Upon the floor or music-stand.
The night wore on, from hour to
 hour,
And still they danced with vim
 and power;
For supple-kneed and light of toe
The Brownies are, as well you
 know,
And such a thing as tiring out
Gives them but small concern, no
 doubt.
As long as darkness hung her pall
In heavy folds around the hall,
The Brownies stayed to dance and
 play,
Until the very break of day.



o dance the figures o'er and o'er,
They lingered on the polished
floor;
No sooner was one party done
Than others the position won.
They chose their partners for the
set,
And bowed, and scraped, and
smiling, met.

As night advanced, and
morning gray
Nigh and still nigher
cast its ray,
The lively Brownies
faster flew,
Across and back,
around and through;
Now down the center, up the side,
Then back to place with graceful
glide—



Until it seemed that even day
Would hardly drive the band
away.

At length some, more upon their
guard
Against surprises, labored hard
To urge their comrades from
the place
Before the sun would show his
face.
They pulled and hauled with
all their might
At those half crazy with delight,
Who still would struggle for a
chance
To have, at least, another dance—
Some figure that was quite forgot,
Although "the finest of the lot."
Another wished to linger still—
In spite of warning words—
until
Each member present on the
floor
Had been his partner twice or
more.



Meantime, outside, the tell-tale
dyes
Of morn began to paint the skies,
And, one by one, the stars of night
Grew pale before the morning's
light.
Alone, bright Venus, in the west,
Upheld her torch and warned the
rest;
While from the hedge the piping
note
Of waking birds began to float;
And crows upon the wooded
hills
Commenced to stir and whet



their bills,
When Brownies scampered
from the place,
And undertook the homeward race.
Nor made a halt in street or square,
Or verdant park, however fair;
But farther from the sight of
man



And light of day, they
quickly ran.
They traveled at their
highest speed,
And swiftly must they go,
indeed;



For, like the spokes of some great wheel,
The rays of light began to steal
Still higher up the eastern sky,
And showed the sun was rolling nigh.



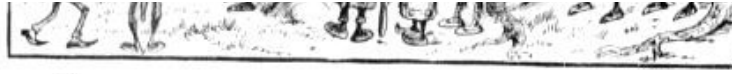
THE BROWNIES' CANDY-PULL.



NE evening, while the Brownies sat
Enjoying free and friendly chat,
Some on the trees, some on the ground,
And others perched on fences round—
One Brownie, rising in his place,
Addressed the band with beaming face.
The listeners gathered with delight
Around the member, bold and bright,
To hear him tell of scenes he'd spied
While roaming through the country wide.
"Last eve," said he, "to shun the blast,
Behind a cottage fence I passed.
While there, I heard a merry rout,
And as the yard was dark without,
I crawled along through weeds and grass,
Through melon-vines and broken glass,
Until I might, unnoticed, win
A glimpse of all the sport within.

At length, below the window-pane,
To reach the sill I stretched in vain;
But, thanks to my
inquiring mind
And sundry bricks, I
chanced to find





The facts I can relate in
full
About that lively candy-
pull.

"An hour or more, I well
believe,
I stood,



their actions to
perceive,
With elbows resting on the
sill,
And nose against the
window still.
I watched them closely at
their fun,
And learned how
everything was
done.

The younger members
took the lead,
And carried on the work
with speed.
With nimble feet they ran
about
From place to place, with
laugh and shout;
But older heads looked on

at the children

the wine,
And cheered the
 youngsters with a
 smile,
And gave advice in
 manner kind
To guide the inexperienced
 mind.
They placed the sugar in a
 pot,
And stirred it round till
 boiling hot;
Then rolled and worked it
 in their hands,
And stretched it out in
 shining bands,
Until it reached across the
 floor,
From mantel-piece to
 kitchen door.

"These eyes of mine for
 many a night
Have not beheld a finer
 sight.
To pull the candy was the
 part
Of some who seemed to
 know the art.
The moon had slipped
 behind the hill,
And hoarse had grown the
 whip-poor-will;
But still, with nose against
 the pane,
I kept my place through
 wind and rain.
There, perched upon the
 shaky pile,
With bated breath I gazed
 the while.
I watched them with the
 sharpest sight

'That I might tell the tale
aright;
For all the active
youngsters there
Appeared to have of work
their share.
Some put fresh sugar in
the pot,
Some kept the fire blazing
hot,
And worked away as best
they could
To keep the stove well
filled with wood.
Indeed, ourselves, with all
our skill,
At moving here and there
at will,
Would have to 'lively' be
and 'tear
Around' to beat those
children there!
Some cut it up, more
passed it round,
While others ate it by the
pound!"



At this, a murmur of
surprise
On every side began to
rise;
Then smiles o'er every
visage flitted,
As wide as cheeks and
ears permitted,
That told what train of
thought had sped
At once through every
Brownie's head

Drowine's head—

A thought of pleasure near
at hand

That well would suit the
cunning band.



HE Brownies act without delay
When new ideas cross their way,
And soon one raised a finger
small
And close attention gained from
all.
They crowded near with anxious
glance
To learn what scheme he could
advance—
What methods mention or employ
To bring about the promised joy.

Said he: "A vacant house is
near.

The owner leaves it every year
For several months, and
pleasure seeks
On ocean waves or mountain
peaks.



The range is there against the wall,
The pots, the pans, the spoons, and all,
While cans of syrup may be found
In every grocer's store around.
The Brownie must be dull and
tame,
And scarce deserves to bear the
name,
Who will not join with heart and
hand
To carry out a scheme so grand."



Another cried: "When to his
bed
The sun to-morrow stoops his
head,
Again we'll muster in full force
And to that building turn our
course."

Next eve they gained the street at
last
That through the silent city

passed;
And soon they paused, their eyes
they raised
And on the vacant mansion gazed.
In vain the miser hides his store,
In vain the merchant bars his
door,
In vain the locksmith changes
keys—
The Brownies enter where they
please.
Through iron doors, through gates
of brass,
And walls of stone they safely
pass,
And smile to think how soon they
can
Upset the studied schemes of
man.
Within that house, without delay,
Behind the guide they worked
their way,
More happy far and full of glee
Than was the owner, out at sea.
The whale, the shark, or fish that
flies
Had less attraction for his eyes
Than had the shining candy-balls
For Brownies, swarming through
his halls.
Soon coal was from the cellar
brought
And kindling wood came, quick
as thought;
Then pots and pans came rattling
in
And syrup sweet, in cans of tin.
Just where the syrup had been
found
It matters not. It was around.
The cunning band was soon
possessed
Of full supplies and of the best:

Next tablespoons of silver fine
 In every hand appeared to shine,
 And ladles long, of costly ware,
 That had been laid away with
 care.

No sooner was the syrup hot
 Than some around the kettle got,



And dabbed away in eager haste
 To be the first to get a taste.
 Then some were scalded when the
 spoon
 Let fall its contents all too soon,



And gave the tongue
 too warm a
 mess
 To carry without
 some distress.
 Then steps were into



service
brought
That dancing-masters
never taught,
And smothered cries
and swinging
hand
Would wake the
wonder of the
band.
And when the candy
boiled until
It could be pulled and
hauled at will,
Take every shape or
twist, and
seem
As free as fancy in a
dream,
The busy, happy-hearted crew



Enjoyed the moments as they
flew.
The Brownies in the building
stayed
And candy ate as fast as made.
But when at length the
brightening sky
Gave warning they must
homeward fly,
They quickly sought the open air
And had but little time to spare.
The shortest way, as often found,
Was o'er the roughest piece of
ground,
Where rocks as large as houses
lay
All scattered round in wild array.
Some covered o'er with clinging

vines,
Some bearing up gigantic pines,
Or spreading oaks, that rooted
fast,
For centuries had stood the blast.



But over all the rugged ground
The Brownies passed with
lightsome bound,
Now jumping clear from block to
block,
Now sliding down the shelving
rock,
Or cheering on the lagging kind
Who here and there would fall
behind.



THE BROWNIES AND THE LOCOMOTIVE.

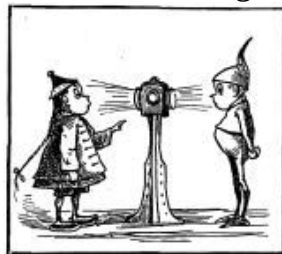


NIGHT the Brownies found
 their way
 To where some tracks and
 switches lay,
 And buildings stood, such
 as are found
 In



every town on
 railroad ground.

They moved about from place to place,
 With prying eyes and cautious pace
 They peeped in shops and gained a view,
 Where cars were standing bright and new;
 While others, that had service known,
 And in some crash were overthrown,
 On jack-screws, blocks, and such affairs,
 Were undergoing full repairs.

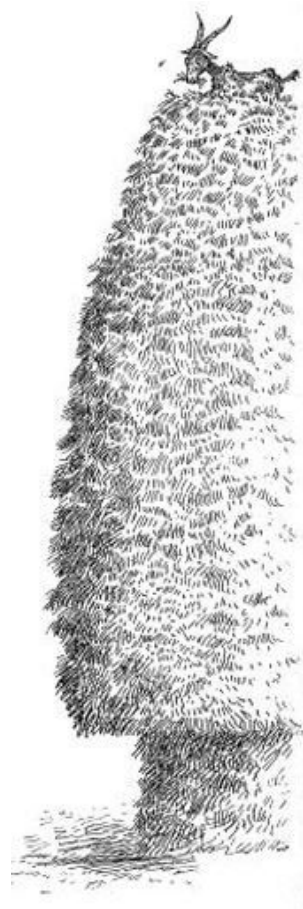


The table that turns end
 for end
 Its heavy load, without a
 bend,
 Was next inspected
 through and
 through
 And tested by the
 wondering crew.
 They scanned the
 signal-lights
 with care
 That told the state of
 switches there,

—
 Showed whether tracks



showed whether tracks
 kept straight
 ahead,
 Or simply to some
 siding led.
 Then round a locomotive strong
 They gathered in an earnest
 throng,
 Commenting on the style it
 showed,
 Its strength and speed upon the
 road.
 Said one: "That 'pilot' placed
 before
 Will toss a cow a block or
 more;
 You'd hardly find a bone intact
 When such a thing her frame
 has racked—
 Above
 t



he fence. and. if you

please,

Above the smoke-stack and the trees
Will go the horns and heels in air,
When hoisted by that same affair."
"Sometimes it saves," another cried,
"And throws an object far aside
That would to powder have been
ground,
If rushing wheels a chance had
found.

I saw a goat tossed from the track
And landed on a farmer's stack,
And though surprised at fate so
strange,
He seemed delighted at the change;
And lived content, on best of fare,
Until the farmer found him there."



Another said: "We'll have some fun
And down the road this engine run.
The steam is up, as gauges show;
She's puffing, ready now to go;



The fireman and the engineer
Are at their supper, in the rear
Of yonder shed. I took a peep,
And found the watchman fast asleep.
So now's our time, if we but haste,
The joys of railway life
to taste.

I know the engine-
driver's art,
Just how to stop,
reverse, and
start;



I've watched them when they little
knew
From every move I knowledge drew;

We'll not be seen till under way,
And then, my friends, here let me
say,

The man or beast will something
lack

Who strives to stop us on the track."
Then some upon the engine stepped,
And some upon the pilot crept,
And more upon the tender found
A place to sit and look around.
And soon away the engine rolled
At speed 'twas fearful to behold;
It seemed they ran, where tracks
were straight,

At least at mile-a-minute rate;
And even

w
h
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urves were short

The engine turned them with a snort
That made the Brownies' hearts the
while

Rise in their throats, for half a mile.
But travelers many dangers run
On safest roads beneath the sun.
They ran through yards, where dogs
came out
To choke with dust that whirled
about,



And so could
neither
growl





THE BROWNIES' FANCY BALL.



T was the season of the year
When people, dressed in
fancy gear,
From every quarter
hurried down
And filled the largest
halls in town;
And there to flute and
fiddle sweet
Went through their sets
with lively feet.
The Brownies were not
slow to note
That fun indeed was now
afloat;
And ere the season
passed away,
Of longest night and
shortest day,
They looked about to find
a hall
Where they could hold
their fancy ball.
Said one: "A room can
soon be found
Where all the band can
troop around;
But want of costumes,
much I fear,
Will bar our pleasure all
the year."
Another said: "One
moment wait!
My eyes have not been
shut of late,—
Don't show a weak and
hopeless mind

Because your knowledge
is confined,—
For I'm prepared to take
the band
To costumes, ready to the
hand,
Of every pattern, new or
old:



The kingly robes, with
chains of gold,
The cloak and plume of

b[^]elted knight,
The pilgrim's hat and
 stockings white,
The dresses for the ladies
 fair,
The gems and artificial
 hair,
The soldier-suits in blue
 and red,
The turban for the Tartar's
 head,
All can be found where I
 will lead,
If friends are willing to
 proceed."



Those knowing best the Brownie way
 Will know there was no long delay,
 Ere to the town he made a break
 With all the Brownies in his wake.

It mattered not that roads
 were long,
 That hills were high or
 winds were
 strong;

Soon robes were found
 on peg and shelf,
 And each one chose to
 suit himself.

The costumes, though
 a world too
 wide,
 And long enough a pair
 to hide

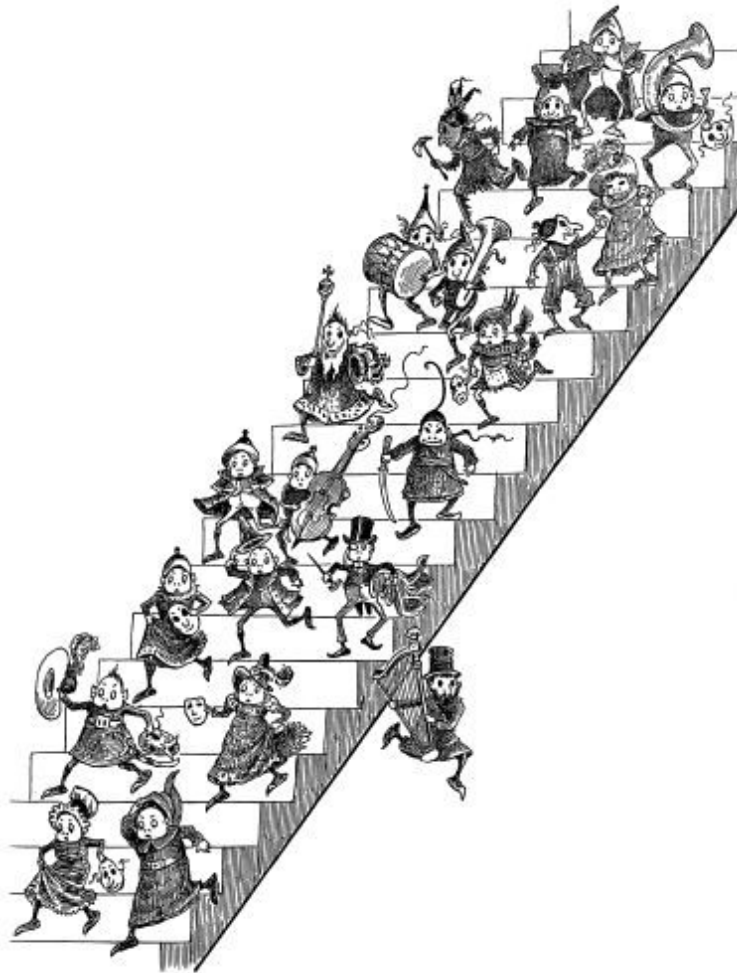


to me,
Were gathered in with
skill and care,
That showed the
tailor's art was
there.
Then out they started
for the hall,
In fancy trappings one
and all;
Some clad like monks
in sable gowns;
And some like kings;
and more like
clowns;
And Highlanders, with naked knees;
And Turks, with turbans like a cheese;



While many members in the line
Were dressed like ladies fair and fine,

And swept along the polished floor
A train that reached a yard or more.



By happy chance some laid their hand
Upon the outfit of a band;
The horns and trumpets took the lead,
Supported well by string and reed;

And violins,
that
would
have
made
A mansion for
the
rogues
that

played,
With flute and
clarione
t
combine
d

In music of the
gayest
kind.

In dances wild and
strange to see
They passed the hours
in greatest glee;
Familiar figures all were
lost

In flowing robes that round
them tossed;

And well-known
faces hid
behind
Queer masks that
quite
confused
the mind.



The queen and clown, a loving pair,
Enjoyed a light fandango there;
While solemn monks of gentle
heart,
In jig and scalp-dance took their
part.

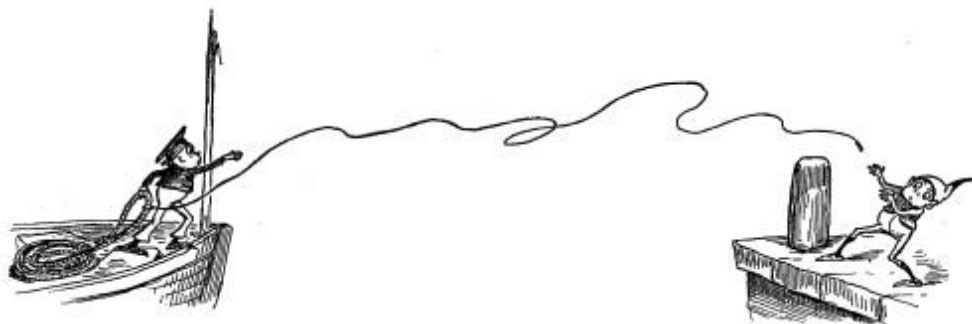


The grand salute, with
courteous words,
The bobbing up and
down, like birds,
The lively skip, the
stately glide,
The double turn, and
twist aside

Were introduced in
proper place
And carried through with
ease and grace.
So great the pleasure
proved to all,
Too



long they tarried
in the hall,
And morning caught
them on the fly,
Ere they could put the garments by!
Then dodging out in great dismay,
By walls and stumps they
made their way;
And not until the evening's
shade
Were costumes in their places
laid.



**THE BROWNIES
AND THE TUGBOAT.**



WHILE Brownies strayed along
a pier
To view the shipping lying
near,
A tugboat drew their gaze at
last;
'Twas at a neighboring
wharf made fast.
Cried one: "See what in
black and red
Below the pilot-house is
spread!
In honor of the Brownie
Band,
It bears our name in letters
grand.
Through all the day she's on
the go;
Now with a laden scow in
tow,
And next with barges two or
three,
Then taking out a ship to
sea,
Or through the Narrows
steaming round
In search of vessels
homeward bound;
She's stanch and true from
stack to keel,
And we should highly
honored feel."
Another said: "An hour ago,
The men went up to see a
show,
And left the tugboat lying
here.

The steam is up, our course
is clear,
We'll crowd on board
without delay
And run her up and down
the bay.
We have indeed a special
claim,
Because she bears the
'Brownie' name.
Before the dawn creeps
through the east
We'll know about her speed
at least,
And prove how such a craft
behaves
When cutting through the
roughest waves.
Behind the wheel I'll take
my stand
And steer her round with
skillful hand,
Now down the river, now
around
The bay, or up the broader
sound;
Throughout the trip I'll keep
her clear
Of all that might awaken
fear.
When hard-a-port the helm I
bring,
Or starboard make a sudden
swing,
The Band can rest as free
from dread
As if they slept on mossy
bed.

I something know about the
 seas,
I've boxed a compass, if you
 please,
And so can steer her east or
 west,
Or north or south, as suits
 me best.
Without the aid of twinkling
 stars
Or light-house lamps, I'll
 cross the bars.
I know when north winds
 nip the nose,
Or sou'-sou'-west the 'pig-
 wind' blows,
As hardy sailors call the
 gale
That from that quarter
 strikes the sail."

A third replied: "No doubt
 you're smart
And understand the pilot's
 art,
But more than one a hand
 should take,
For all our lives will be at
 stake.
In spite of eyes and ears and
 hands,
And all the skill a crew
 commands,
How oft collisions crush the
 keel
And give the fish a
 sumptuous meal!
Too many rocks around the

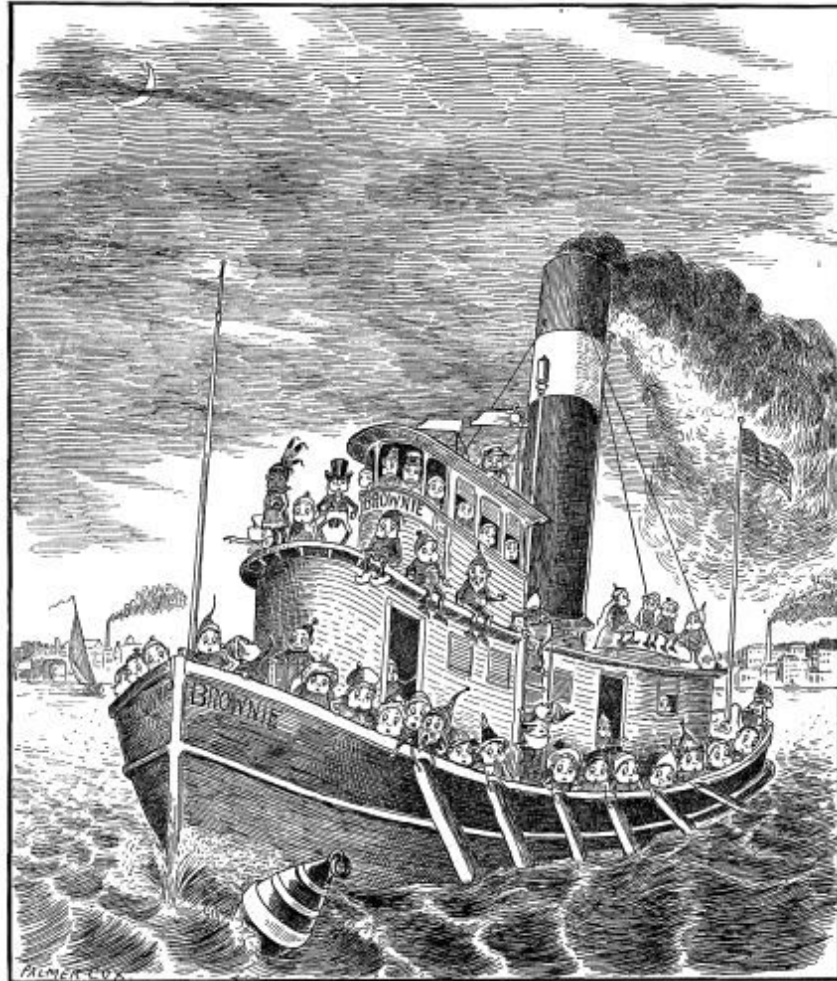
bay
Stick up their heads to bar
the way.
Too many vessels, long and
wide,
At anchor in the channel
ride
For us to show ourselves
unwise
And trust to but one pair of
eyes."

Ere long the tugboat
swinging clear
Turned bow to stream and
left the pier,
While many Brownies,
young and old,
From upper deck to lower
hold
Were crowding round in
happy vein
Still striving better views to
gain.
Some watched the waves
around them roll;
Some stayed below to
shovel coal,



From hand to hand, with
pitches strong,
They passed the rattling
loads along.

Some at the engine took a
place,
More to the pilot-house
would race



To keep a sharp lookout
ahead,
Or man the wheel as fancy
led.
But accidents we oft record,
However well we watch and
ward,
And vessels often go to
wreck
With careful captains on the
deck;





They had mishaps that
night, for still,
In spite





of all their care and
skill,
While running straight or
turning round
In river, bay, or broader
sound,
At times they ran upon a
rock,
And startled by the sudden
shock
Some timid Brownies,
turning pale,
Would spring at once across
the rail;
And then, repenting, find all
hope
Of life depended on a rope,
That willing hands were
quick to throw
And hoist them from the
waves below.
Sometimes too near a ship
they ran
For peace of mind; again,
their plan
Would come to naught
through lengthy tow
Of barges passing to and
fro.
The painted buoys around
the bay
At times occasioned some

dismay—
They took them for
torpedoes dread
That might the boat in
fragments spread,
Awake the city's slumbering
crowds,
And hoist the band among
the clouds.
But thus, till hints of dawn
appeared
Now here, now there, the
boat was steered
With many joys and many
fears,
That some will bear in mind
for years;
But at her pier once more
she lay
When night gave place to
creeping day.

THE BROWNIES' TALLY-HO.



s shades of evening closed
around,
The Brownies, from some
wooded ground,
Looked out to view with
staring eye
A Tally-Ho, then passing by.
Around the park they saw it
roll,
Now sweeping round a
wooded knoll,
Now rumbling o'er an
arching bridge,

Now hid behind a rocky ridge,
Now wheeling out again in view
To whirl along some avenue.
They hardly could restrain a shout
When they observed the grand turnout.
The long, brass horn, that trilled so loud,
The prancing horses, and the crowd





Of people perched so high
in air
Pleased every wondering
Brownie there.
Said one: "A rig like this we
see

Would suit the
Brownies to
a T!
And I'm the one,
here let me
say,



To put such
pleasures in our way:
I know the very place to go
To-night to find a Tally-Ho.
It never yet has borne a load

Of happy hearts along the
road;
But, bright and new in every
part
'Tis ready for an early start.
The horses in the stable
stand
With harness ready for the
hand;
If all agree, we'll take a ride
For miles across the country
wide."
Another said: "The plan is
fine;
You well deserve to head
the line;

But, on the road, the reins
I'll draw;

I know the way to
'gee' and 'haw,'
And how to turn a
corner round,
And still keep wheels
upon the
ground."



Another answered: "No, my friend,
We'll not on one alone depend;
But three or four the reins will hold,

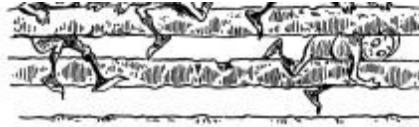
That horses may be well
controlled.

The curves are short, the
hills are steep,
The horses fast, and ditches
deep,
And at some places half the
band
May have to take the lines
in hand."

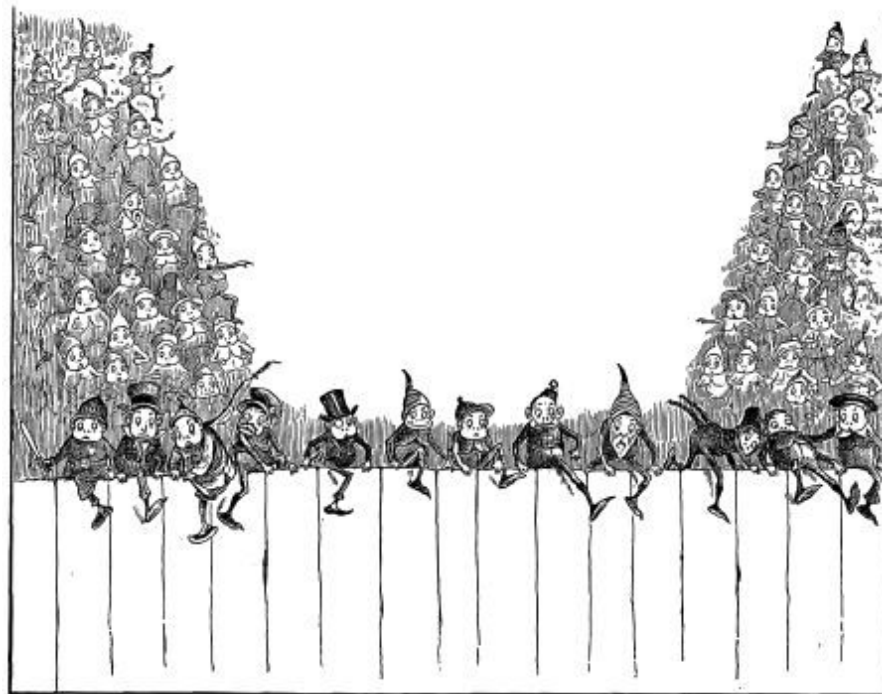


That night,
according to
their plan,
The Brownies to the
stable ran;
Through swamps
they cut to
reach the
place,





And cleared the
fences in
their race
As lightly as the
swallow flies
To catch its morning
meal
supplies.
Though, in the
race, some
clothes
were
soiled,
And stylish
shoes
complet
ely
spoiled,



Across the roughest hill or

ACROSS the roughest hill or
rock
They scampered like a
frightened flock,
Now o'er inclosures knee and
knee,
With equal speed they
clambered free
And soon with faces all aglow
They crowded round the Tally-
Ho;



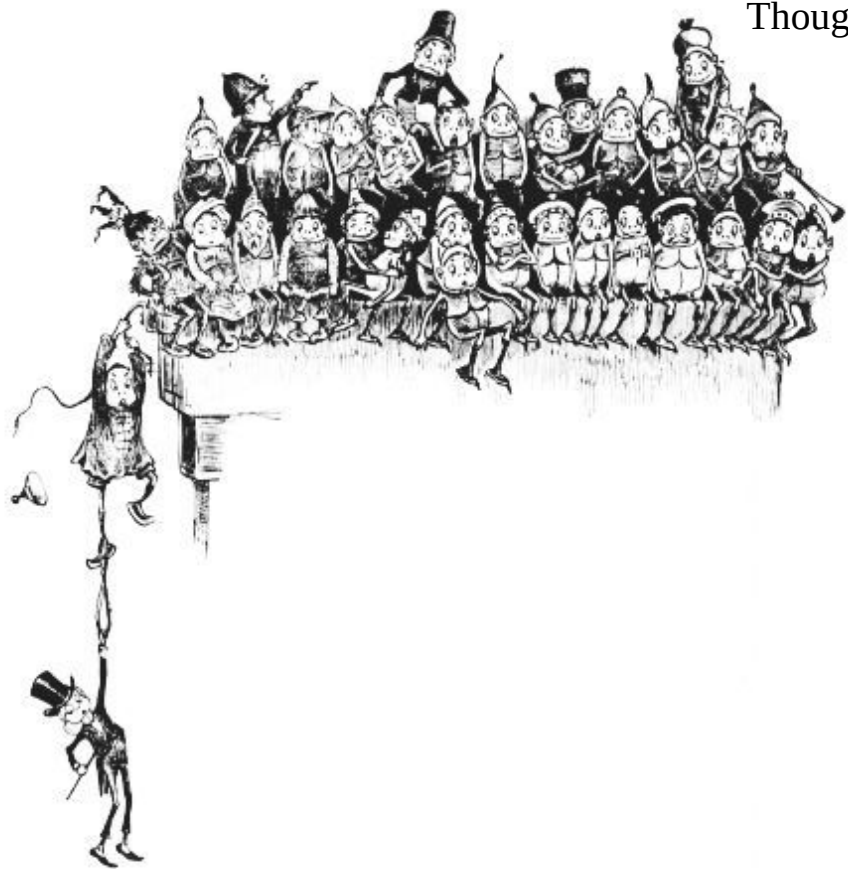
But little time they stood to
stare
Or smile upon the strange
affair.
As many hands make labor
light,
And active fingers win the
fight,
Each busy Brownie played his
part,
And soon 't was ready for the
start.

But ere they took their seats to
ride
By more than one the horns
were tried,
Each striving with tremendous
strain
The most enlivening sound to
gain,





And prove he had a special
right
To blow the horn throughout
the night.



Thoug

h some were
crowded in a seat,
And some were forced to
keep their feet
Or sit upon another's lap,
And some were hanging

And some were hanging
to a strap,
With merry laugh and
ringing shout,
And tooting horns, they
drove about.

A dozen miles, perhaps,
or more,
The lively band had
traveled o'er,
Commenting on their
happy lot
And keeping horses on
the trot,

When, as they passed a
stunted oak
A wheel was caught, the
axle broke!



Then some went out
with sudden
pitch,
And some were tumbled in the ditch,
And one jumped off to save his neck,
While others still hung to the wreck.

Confusion reigned, for
coats were rent,
And hats were
crushed, and
horns were
bent,



And
what began
with fun and
clatter
Had turned to quite a
serious

matter.



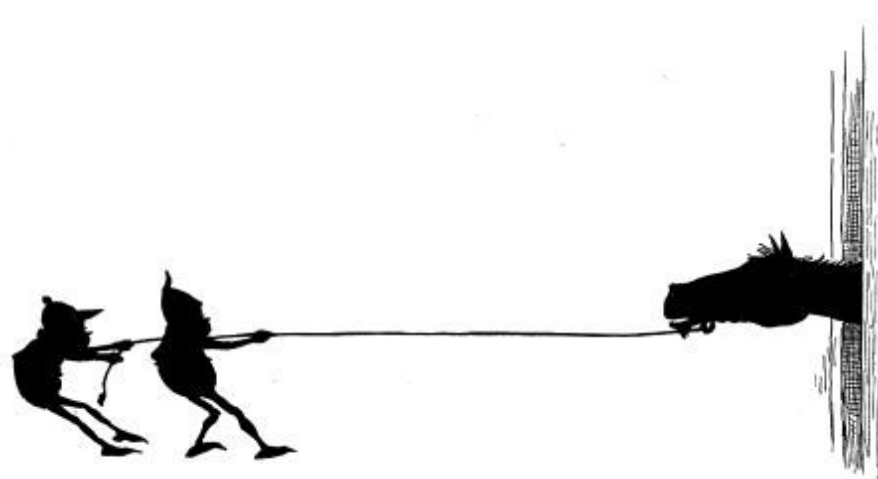
Some blamed the drivers, others
thought
The tooting horns the trouble
brought.
More said, that they small wisdom
showed,
Who left the root so near the road.
But while they talked about their
plight
Upon them burst the morning light
With all the grandeur and the sheen
That June could lavish on the
scene.
So hitching horses where they
could,
The Brownies scampered
for the wood.

And lucky were the
Brownies spry:
A dark and deep ravine
was nigh
That seemed to
swallow
them alive



So quick were they to jump and dive,
To safely hide from blazing day
That fast had driven night away,
And forced them to leave all repairs
To other heads and hands than theirs.

THE BROWNIES ON



THE RACE-TRACK.



HILE Brownies moved
 around one night
 A seaside race-track came
 in sight.
 "'T is here," said one, "the
 finest breed
 Of horses often show
 their speed;
 Here, neck and neck, and
 nose and nose,
 Beneath the jockeys'
 urging blows,



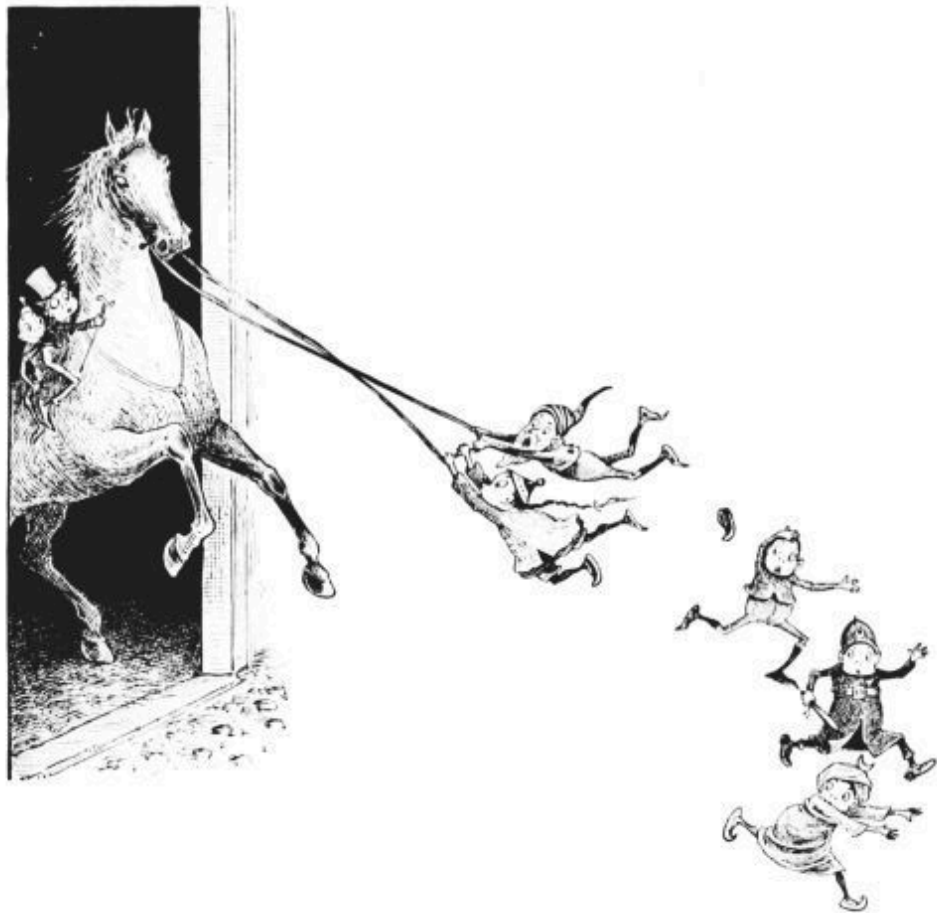
They
 sweep around the
 level mile
 The people shouting all the while;
 And climbing up or crowding through
 To gain a better point of view,
 So they can see beyond a doubt
 How favorites are holding out."
 Another said: "I know the place
 Where horses wait to-morrow's race;
 We'll strap the saddles on their back,
 And lead them out upon the track.
 Then some will act the jockey's part,
 And some, as judges, watch the start,
 And down the winners fly to show

And drop the crimson flag to show
The start is fair and all must go."

Ere long, the Brownies
turned to haul
Each wondering race-horse
from his stall.

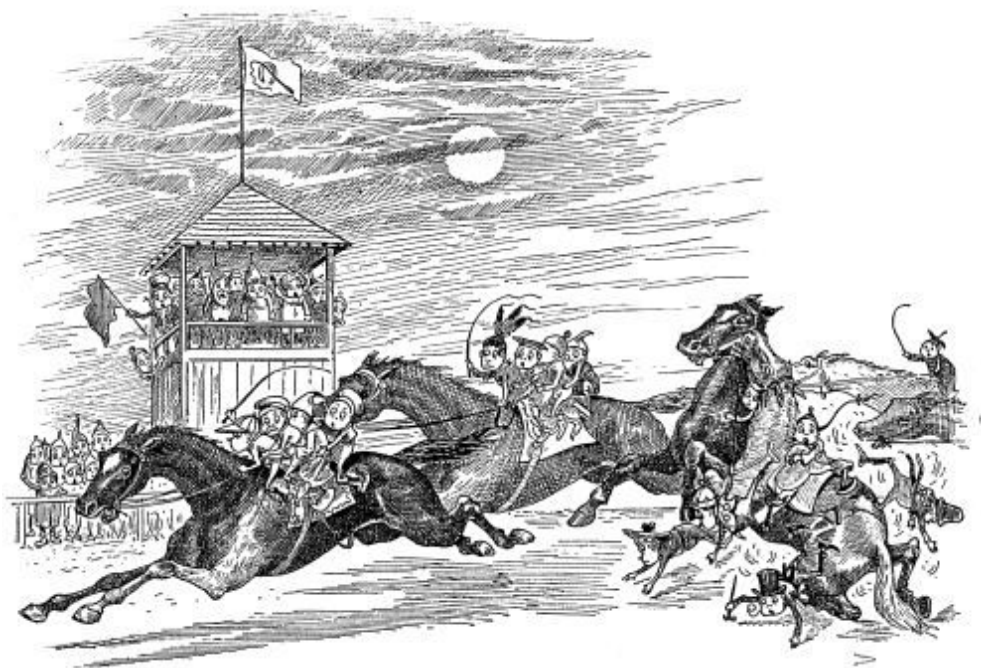
They bridled them without
delay,

And saddles strapped in proper way.
Some restless horses rearing there



Would toss their holders high in air,
And test the courage and the art
Of those who took an active part.
Said one: "I've lurked in yonder wood,
And watched the races when I could.
I know how all is done with care
When thus for racing they prepare;
That every handle must be tight

Now every buckle must be tight,
And every strap and stirrup right,
Or jockeys would be on the ground
Before they circled half way round."
When all was ready for the show
Each Brownie rogue was nowise slow
At climbing up to take a place
And be a jockey in the race.
Full half a dozen Brownies tried
Upon one saddle now to ride;
But some were into service pressed
As judges to control the rest—
To see that rules were kept complete,
And then decide who won the heat.
A dozen times they tried to start;
Some shot ahead like jockeys smart,
And were prepared to take the lead
Around the track at flying speed.
But others were so far behind,
On horses of unruly mind,
The judges from the stand declare
The start was anything but fair.





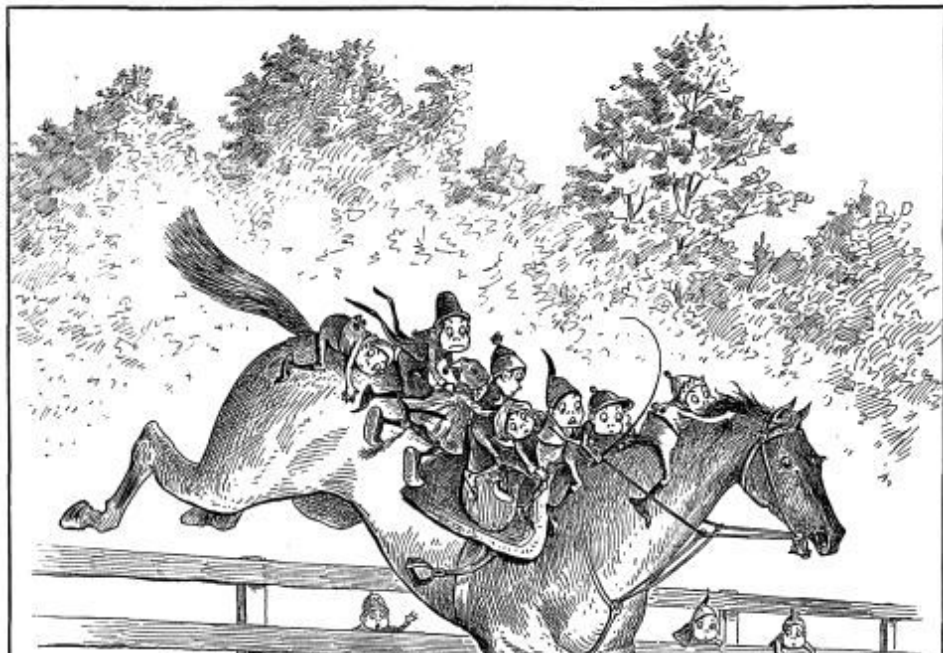
So back they'd jog at
his command,
In better shape to pass
the stand.
Indeed it was no
simple trick
To ride those horses,
shy and quick,
And only for the
mystic art
That is the Brownies'
special part,
A dozen backs, at least, had
found
A resting-place upon the
ground.

The rules of racing were not
quite
Observed in full upon that
night.
Around and round the track
they flew,
In spite of all the judge
could do.
The race, he tried to let
them know,
Had been decided long ago.
But still the horses kept the
track,
With Brownies clinging to
each back.



Some racers of the
jumping kind
At times disturbed the
riders' mind
When from the track
they sudden

they sudden
wheeled,
And over fences took
the field,
As if they hoped in
some such
mode
To rid themselves of
half their load.
But horses, howsoever
smart,
Are not a match for
Brownie art,
For still the riders
stuck through
all,
In spite of fence, or
ditch, or
wall.
Some clung to saddle, some to
mane,
While others tugged at bridle
rein.





So all the steeds found it would
pay
To let the Brownies have their
way,
Until a glimpse of rising sun
Soon made them leave the place
and run.



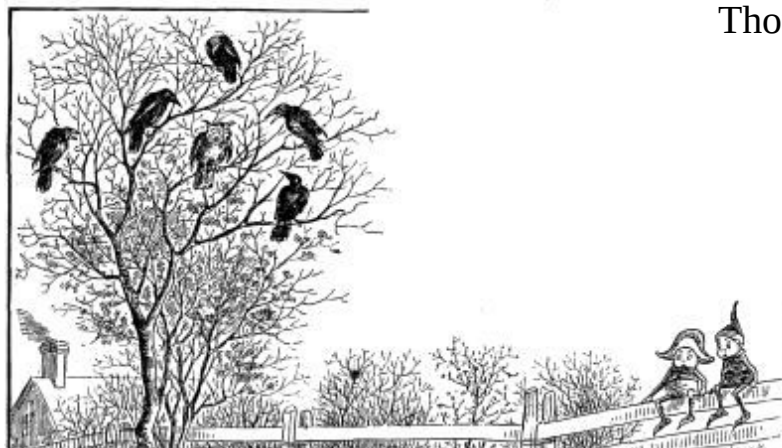
THE BROWNIES' BIRTHDAY DINNER.

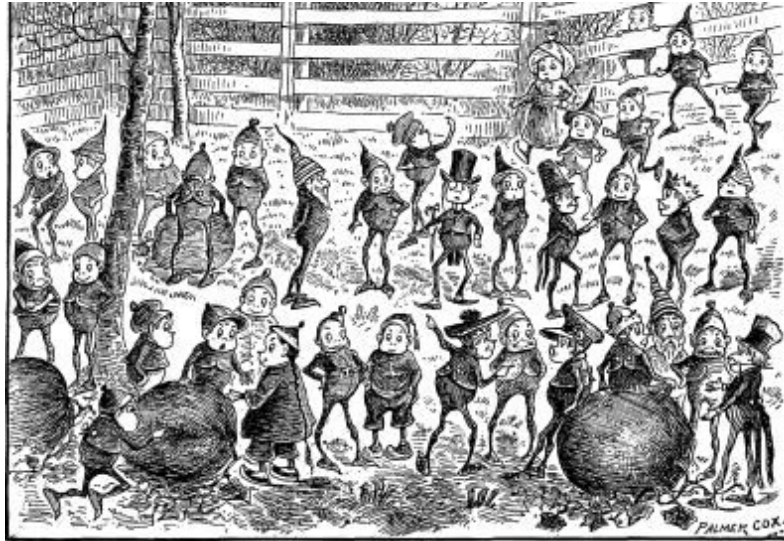


HEN people through the
county planned
To give their public
dinner
grand,
The Brownies met at
day's decline
To have a birthday
banquet fine.

"The proper things," a speaker cried,
"Await us here on every side;
We simply have to reach and take
And choose a place to boil and bake.
With meal and flour at our feet,
And wells of water pure and sweet,
That Brownie must be dull indeed
Who lacks the gumption to proceed.
We'll peel the pumpkins, ripened well,
And scoop them hollow, like a shell,
Then slice them up the proper size
To make at length those famous pies,
For which the people, small and great,
Are ever quick to reach a plate."
This pleased them all; so none were slow
In finding work at which to go.
A stove that chance threw in their way
Was put in shape without delay.

Thoug





h doors were cracked, and legs were
rare,
The spacious oven still was there,
Where pies and cakes and puddings wide
Might bake together side by side.

The level top, though incomplete,
 Gave pots and pans a welcome seat,
 Where stews could steam and
 dumplings found
 A fitting place to roll around.
 Some lengths of pipe were raised on high
 That made the soot and cinders fly,
 And caused a draught throughout the wreck
 That door or damper failed to check.



The rogues who undertook the part,
 That tries the cook's delightful art,
 Had smarting hands and faces red
 Before the table-cloth was spread;



But what cared they at
 such an hour
 For singeing flame or
 scalding
 shower?



Such ills are always
reckoned slight
When great successes
are in sight.
There cakes and tarts
and cookies
fine,
Of both the "leaf" and
"notched"
design,
Were ranged in rows
around the pan
That into heated ovens
ran;
Where, in what seemed
a minute's
space,

Another batch would take their place;
While birds, that had secured repose
Above the reach of Reynard's nose,
Without the aid of wings came down
To be at midnight roasted brown.
They found some boards and benches laid
Aside by workmen at their trade,
And these upon the green were placed
By willing hands with proper haste.
Said one, who board and bench combined:
"All art is not to cooks confined,
And some expertness we can show
As well as those who mix the dough."

And all was as the
speaker said;

In fact, they were some
points ahead;

For





when the cooks their
triumphs showed,
The table waited for its load.
The knives and forks and dishes
white
By secret methods came to light.
Much space would be required to tell
Just how the table looked so well;
But kitchen cupboards, three or four,
Must there have yielded up their store;
For all the guests on every side
With full equipments were supplied.



When people find a carver hacked,
A saucer chipped, or platter cracked,
They should be somewhat slow to claim
That someone else is to blame.

That servants are the ones to blame;

For Brownies
may have
used the
ware
And failed to
show the
proper
care.



A few, as waiters, passed about
New dishes when the old gave out,
And saw the plates, as soon as bare,
Were heaped again with something rare.
No member, as you may believe,
Was anxious such a place to leave,
Until he had a taste at least
Of all the dishes in the feast.
The Brownies, when they
break their fast,
Will eat as long as viands last,
And even birds can not depend
On crumbs or pickings at the
end:
The plates were scraped, the
kettles clean,
And not a morsel to be seen,
Ere Brownies from that table
ran
To shun the prying eyes of
man.



THE BROWNIES' HALLOW-EVE.



N Hallow-eve, that night of
fun,
When elves and goblins
frisk and run,
And many games and
tricks are tried
At every pleasant
fireside,
The Brownies halted to
survey
A village that below them
lay,
And wondered as they
rested there
To hear the laughter fill the
air
That from the happy children
came
As they enjoyed some pleasant
game.
Said one: "What means this
merry flow
That comes so loudly from
below,
Uncommon pleasures must
abound
Where so much laughter can
be found."
Another said: "Now, by your
leave,
I'll tell you 't is All-Hallow-
eve,
When people meet to have
their sport
At curious games of every
sort;
I know them all from first to

last,
And now, before the night has
passed,
For some convenient place
we'll start
Without delay to play our
part."
Two dozen mouths
commenced to show
Their teeth in white and even
row;
Two dozen voices cried with
speed,
"The plan is good we're all
agreed."



And in a trice four dozen feet
Went down the hill with even
beat.
Without a long or wearying
race
The Brownies soon secured a
place
That answered well in every
way
For all the games they wished
to play.
There tubs of water could be
found,
By which to stoop or kneel
around,



And strive to bring the pennies
out
That on the bottom slipped
about.
Then heads were wet and
shoulders, too,
Where some would still the
coin pursue,
And mouth about now here
and there
Without a pause or breath of
air
Until in pride, with joyful
cries,
They held aloft the captured

prize.
More stood the tempting bait
beneath,
And with a hasty snap of teeth
The whirling apple thought to
claim
And shun the while the
candle's flame,—
But found that with such
pleasure goes
An eye-brow singed, or
blistered nose.



More named the oats as people
do
To try which hearts are false,
which true,
And on the griddle placed the
pair
To let them part or smoulder
there;
And smiled to see, through
woe or weal,
How often hearts were true as
steel.

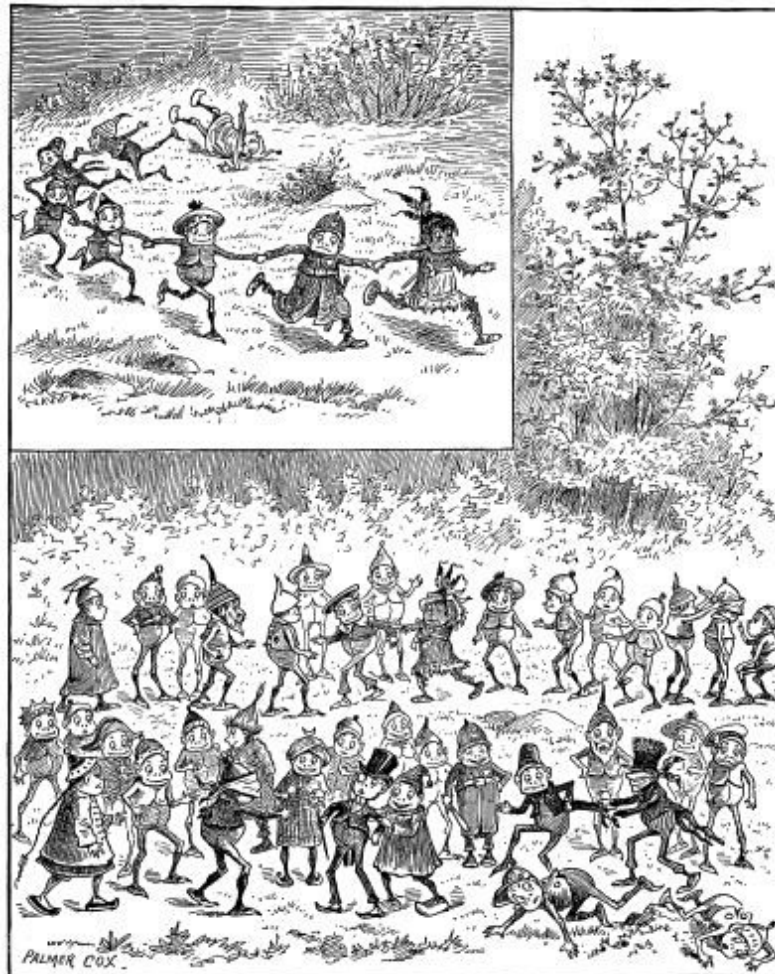




Still others tried to read their
 fate
 Or fortune in a dish or plate,
 Learn whether they would
 ever wed,
 Or lead a single life instead;
 Or if their mate would be a
 blessing,
 Or prove a partner most
 distressing.

Then others in the open air,
 Of fun and frolic had their
 share;
 Played "hide and seek," and
 "blindman's buff,"
 And "tag" o'er places smooth
 or rough,

And "snap the whip" and "trip
the toe,"
And games that none but
Brownies know.
As if their lives at stake were
placed,
They jumped around and
dodged and raced,
And tumbled headlong to the
ground
When feet some hard
obstruction found;
At times across the level
mead,
Some proved their special
claims to speed,





And as reward of
merit wore
A wreath of green
till sport was
o'er.



The hours flew past
as hours will
When joys do every
moment fill;



The moon grew
weak and
said good-
night,



And turned her
pallid face
from sight;



Then weakening
stars began
to fail,



But still the

B
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e vale;



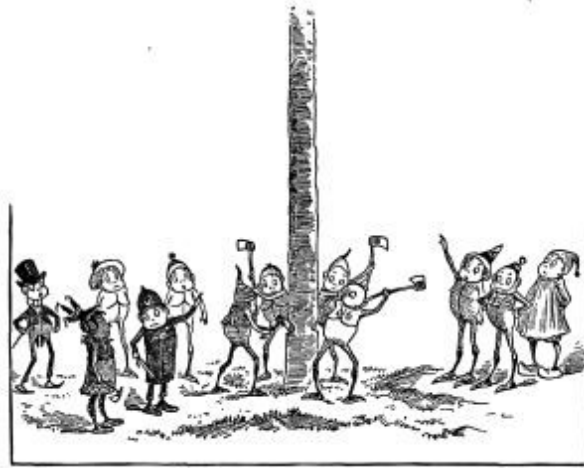
Full many a time
had hours
retired

~~~~~  
Much faster than the  
band desired,  
And pleasure  
seemed too  
sweet to lay  
Aside, because of  
coming day,  
But never yet with  
greater pain  
Did they behold the  
crimson stain  
That morning spread  
along the  
sky,  
And told them they  
must  
homeward  
fly





# THE BROWNIES' FLAG-POLE.





HE Brownies through a  
village bound,  
Paused in their run to  
look around,  
And wondered why the



central square  
Revealed no flag-pole tall  
and fair.  
Said one: "Without delay  
we'll go  
To woods that stand some  
miles below.  
The tall spruce lifts its  
tapering crest

So straight and high  
    above the rest,  
We soon can choose a  
    flag-pole there  
To ornament this village  
    square.  
Then every one a hand  
    will lend  
To trim it off from end to  
    end,  
To peel it smooth and  
    paint it white,  
And hoist it in the square  
    to-night."

Then to the woods the  
    Brownies ran  
At once to carry out their  
    plan;

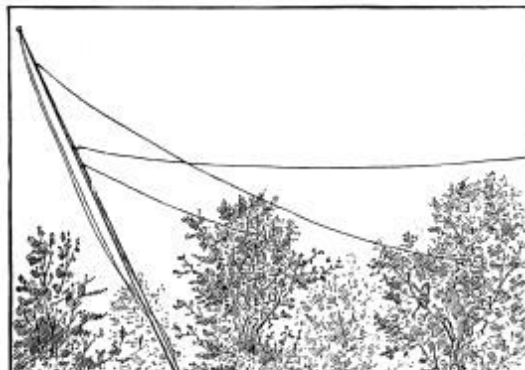
While some ran here and there with speed  
For implements to serve their need,  
Some rambled through the forest free  
To find the proper kind of tree,  
Then climbed the tree while yet it stood  
To learn if it was sound and good,





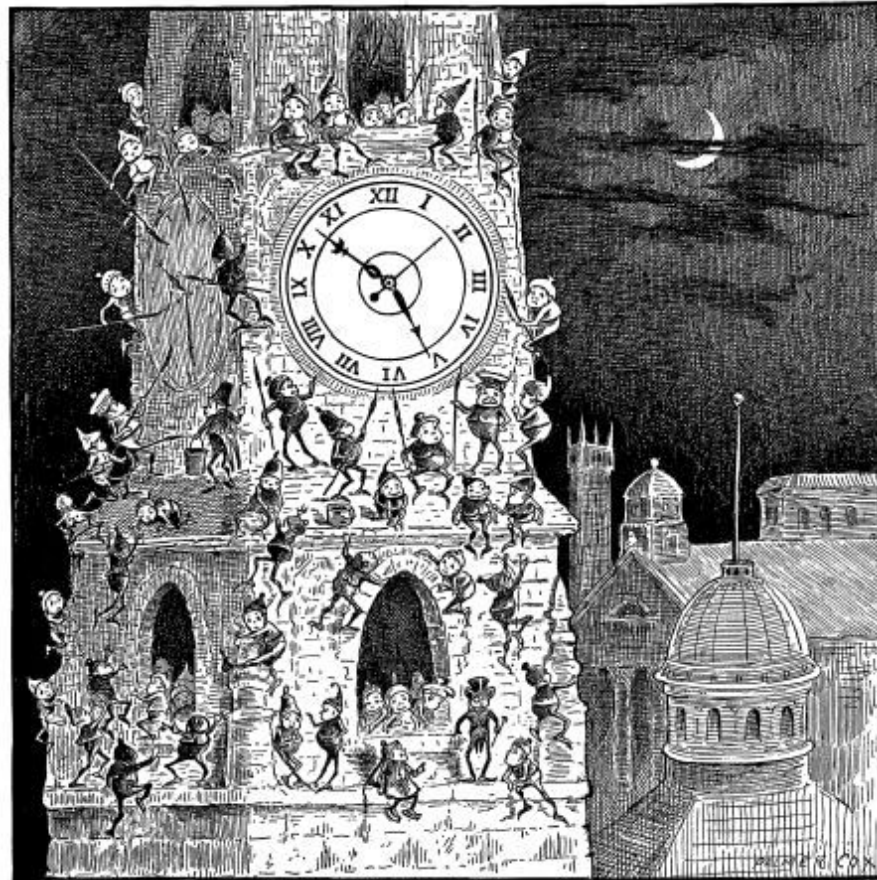
Without a flaw, a  
twist, or  
bend,  
To mar its looks  
from end to  
end.  
When one was found  
that suited  
well,  
To work the active  
Brownies  
fell;

And soon with sticks beneath their  
load,  
The band in grand procession strode;  
It gave them quite enough to do  
To safely put the project through,  
But when they reached the square, at  
last,  
Some ropes around the pole were  
passed





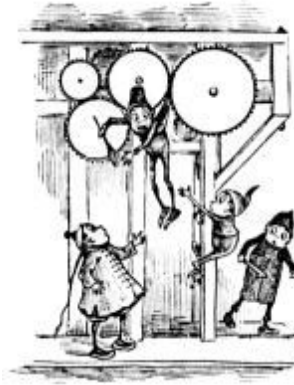
And from the tops of maples tall  
A crowd began to pull and haul,  
While others gathered at the base  
Until the flag-pole stood in place.



For Brownies seldom idle stand  
When there is fun or work on hand.  
At night when darkness wraps us

round  
They come from secret haunts  
profound,  
With brushes, pots of paint, and all,  
They clamber over fence and wall;  
And soon on

objects  
here  
and  
there  
That hold  
position  
s high  
in air,



And most  
attract the human eye,  
The marks of Brownie fingers lie.  
Sometimes with feet that never tire  
They climb the tall cathedral spire;  
When all the town is still below,  
Save watchmen pacing to and fro,  
By light of moon, and stars alone,  
They dust the marble and the stone,  
And with their brushes, small and  
great,  
They paint and gild the dial-plate;  
And bring the figures plain in sight  
That all may note Time's rapid flight.  
And accidents they often know  
While through the heavy works they  
go,  
Where slowly turning wheels at last  
In bad position hold them fast.  
But Brownies, notwithstanding all  
The hardships that may them befall,  
Still persevere in every case  
Till morning drives them from the  
place.

And then with happy hearts they fly  
To hide away from human eye.



# **THE BROWNIES ON THE CANAL.**



NE night the Brownies stood  
beside  
A long canal, whose silent  
tide  
Connected seaboard cities  
great  
With inland sections of the  
state.  
The laden boats, so large  
and strong,  
Were tied to trees by  
hawsers long;  
No boatmen stood by helm  
or oar,  
No mules were tugging on  
the shore;  
All work on land and water  
too  
Had been abandoned by the  
crew.  
Said one: "We see, without  
a doubt,  
What some dispute has  
brought about.  
Perhaps a strike for greater  
pay,  
For even rates, or shorter  
day,  
Has caused the boats to  
loiter here  
With cargoes costing some  
one dear.  
These cabbages so large and  
round  
Should, long ere this, the  
dish have found,  
Upon some kitchen-stove or

range  
To spread an odor rich and  
strange;  
Those squashes, too, should  
not be lost  
By long exposure to the  
frost,  
When they would prove so  
great a prize  
To old and young, if baked  
in pies.  
And then those pippins, ripe  
and fair,  
From some fine orchard  
picked with care,  
Should not to rot and ruin  
go,  
Though work is hard or  
wages low,  
When thousands would be  
glad to stew  
The smallest apples there in  
view."





Another said: "We lack the  
might  
To set the wrongs of labor  
right,  
But by the power within us  
placed  
We'll see that nothing goes  
to waste.  
So every hand must be  
applied  
That boats upon their way  
may glide."

Then some ran here and  
there with speed  
To find a team to suit their  
need.  
A pair of mules, that grazed  
about  
The grassy banks, were  
fitted out



With straps  
and  
ropes  
witho  
ut  
delay  
To start the  
boats  
upon  
their

way;  
And next  
some  
strayi  
ng  
goats  
were  
found

,  
Where in a  
yard  
they  
nibbl  
ed  
round

Destroying  
plants  
of  
rarest  
kind

That owners  
in the  
town  
could  
find.

Soon, taken from their rich  
repast,  
They found themselves in  
harness fast;  
Then into active service  
pressed  
They trod the tow-path with  
the rest.



On deck some Brownies took their stand  
To man the helm, or give command,  
And oversee the work; while more  
Stayed with the teams upon the shore.



At times the rope would drag along  
And catch on snags or branches  
long,



And cause  
delays  
they ill  
could  
bear,  
For little time  
they  
had to

spare.

With accidents  
they  
often  
met,

And some  
were  
bruised  
and  
more  
were  
wet;

Some tumbled  
headlo  
ng  
down  
the  
hold;

And some  
from  
heapin  
g  
cargoe  
s  
rolled.

But what care Brownies for a  
bruise,  
Or garments wet, from hat to shoes,  
When enterprises bold and new  
Must ere the dawn be  
carried through?  
If half the band were  
drenched, no doubt  
The work would still be  
carried out,  
For extra strength would



then be round  
In those who still were safe  
and sound.



But once, when "low  
bridge!" was the  
shout

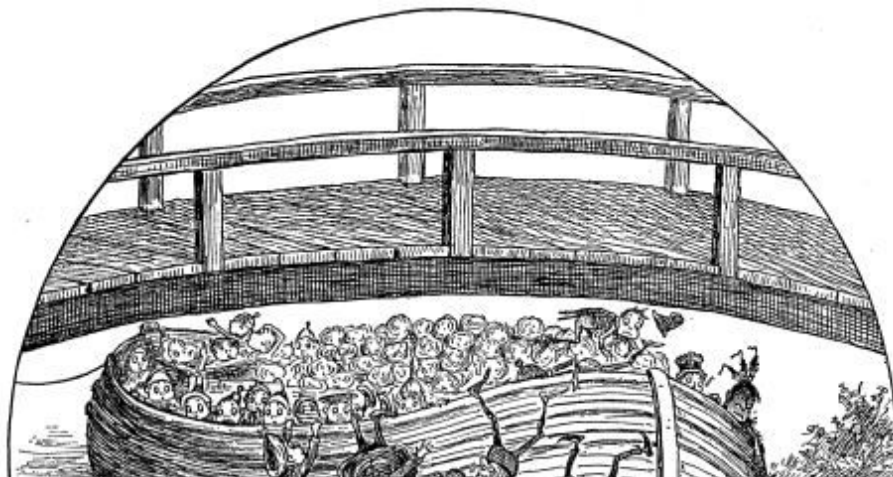
They stood and stared or ran about  
Till in the water, heels o'er head,  
Some members of the band were spread.

A few could swim, and held their own;  
But more went downward like a stone  
Until, without the plummet's aid,  
They learned how deep canals are  
made.

In spite of all the kicks and flings  
That fright at such a moment  
brings,  
Through lack of art, or weight of  
fear,

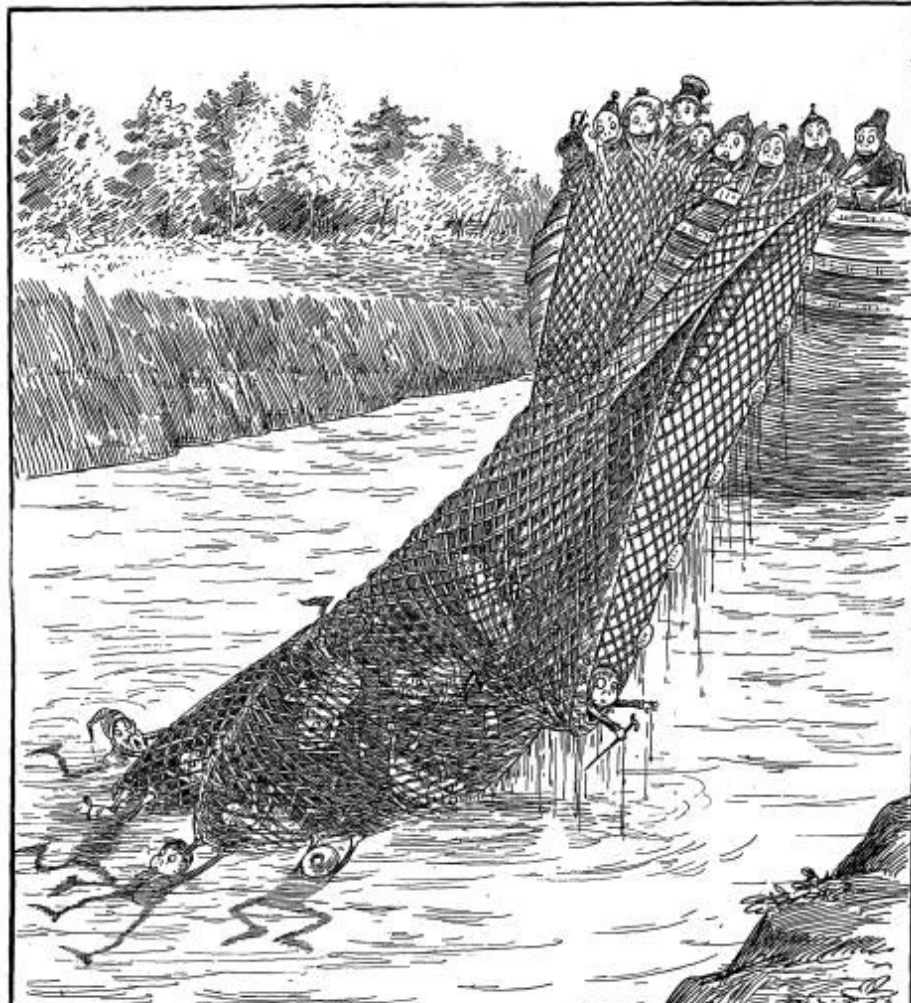
It looked as if their end was near.  
The order now to stop the team  
Would pass along with sign and  
scream,

And those on land would know by  
this  
That something startling was amiss;





And those on board could plainly  
see  
Unless assistance there could be,  
In shape of ropes and fingers  
strong,  
There'd be some vacancies, ere  
long!





By chance a net was to be had,  
That boatmen used for catching  
shad—

A gill-net of the strongest kind,  
For heavy catches well designed;  
Few shad against its meshes ran  
But left their bones on some one's  
pan,

This bulky thing the active crew  
Far overboard with promptness  
threw.

A hold at once some Brownies  
found,

While others in its folds were  
bound,

Until like fish in great dismay  
Inside the net they struggling lay.  
But willing hands were overhead,  
And quickly from the muddy bed  
Where shedder crabs and turtles  
crawled

The dripping net was upward  
hauled,

With all the Brownies clinging fast,  
Till safe on deck they stood at last.

Sometimes a mule  
fell off the  
road

And in the stream  
with all its  
load.





Then precious time would be  
consumed  
Before the trip could be resumed.  
Thus on they went from mile to  
mile,  
With many strange mishaps the  
while,  
But working bravely through the  
night  
Until the city came in sight.

Said one: "Now, thanks to bearded  
goats  
And patient mules, the heavy boats  
For hours have glided on their way,  
And reached the waters of the bay.  
But see, the sun's about to show  
His colors to the world below,  
And other birds than those of night  
Begin to take their morning flight.  
Our time is up; we've done our  
best;  
The ebbing tide must do the rest;  
Now drifting downward to their  
pier  
Let barges unassisted steer,  
While we make haste, with nimble  
feet,  
To find in woods a safe retreat."

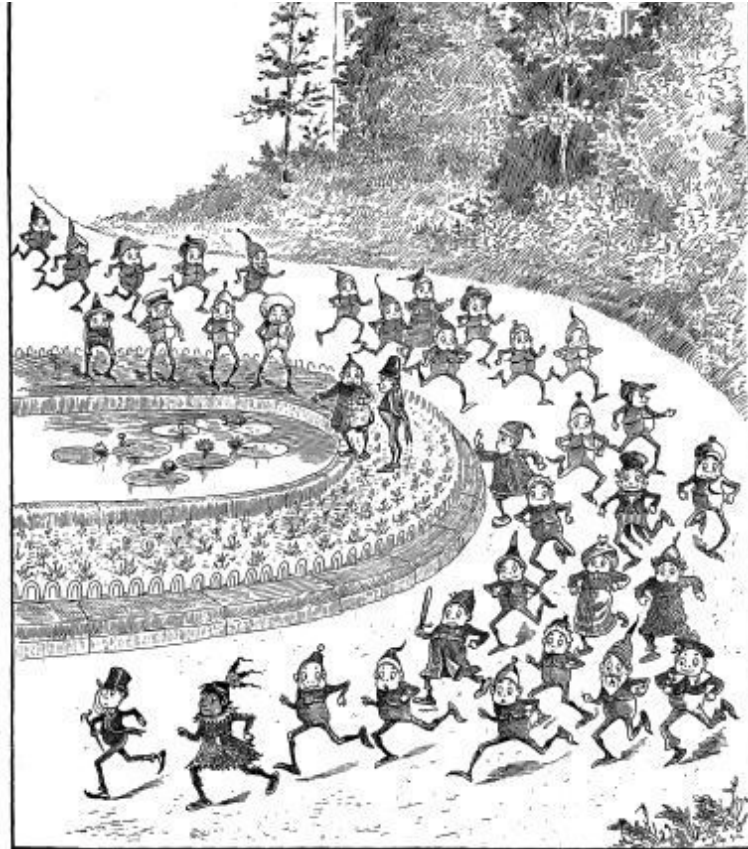




**THE BROWNIES IN THE STUDIO.**

THE Brownies once  
approached in glee  
A slumbering city by the  
sea.  
"In yonder town," the leader  
cried,  
"I hear the artist does reside  
Who pictures out, with  
patient hand,  
The doings of the Brownie  
band."  
"I'd freely give," another  
said,  
"The cap that now protects  
my head,  
To find the room, where,  
day by day,  
He shows us at our work or  
play."  
A third replied: "Your cap  
retain  
To shield your poll from  
snow or rain.  
His studio is farther down,  
Within a corner-building  
brown.  
So follow me a mile or  
more  
And soon we'll reach the  
office door."  
Then through the park,  
around the square,  
And down the broadest  
thoroughfare,





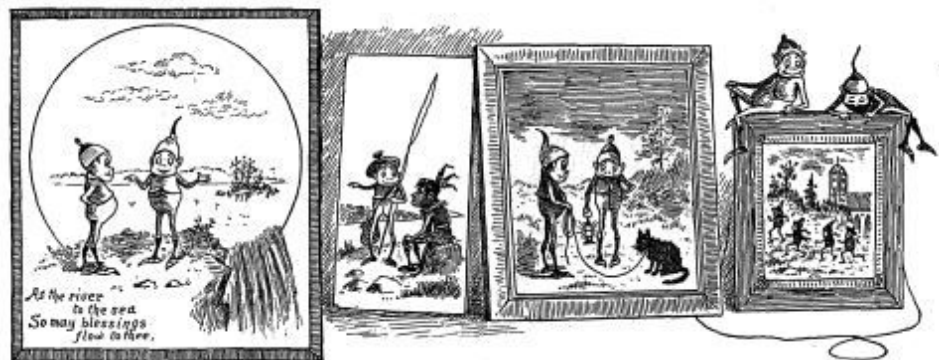
The anxious Brownies  
quickly passed,  
And reached the building  
huge at last.





They paused awhile to view  
the sight,  
To speak about its age and  
height,  
And read the signs, so long  
and wide,  
That met the gaze on every  
side.  
But little time was wasted  
there,  
For soon their feet had  
found the stair.  
And next the room, where  
oft are told  
Their funny actions, free  
and bold,  
Was honored by a friendly  
call  
From all the Brownies, great  
and small.

Then what a gallery they  
found,  
As here and there they  
moved around—



For now they gaze upon a  
scene  
That showed them sporting  
on the green;  
Then, hastening o'er the  
fields with speed  
To help some farmer in his  
need.  
Said one, "Upon this desk,  
no doubt,  
Where now we cluster  
round about,  
Our



doings have been  
plainly told  
From month to month, through heat and cold.  
And there's the ink, I apprehend,  
On which our very lives depend.  
Be careful, moving to and fro,  
Lest we upset it as we go.

For who can  
tell  
what  
tales  
untold

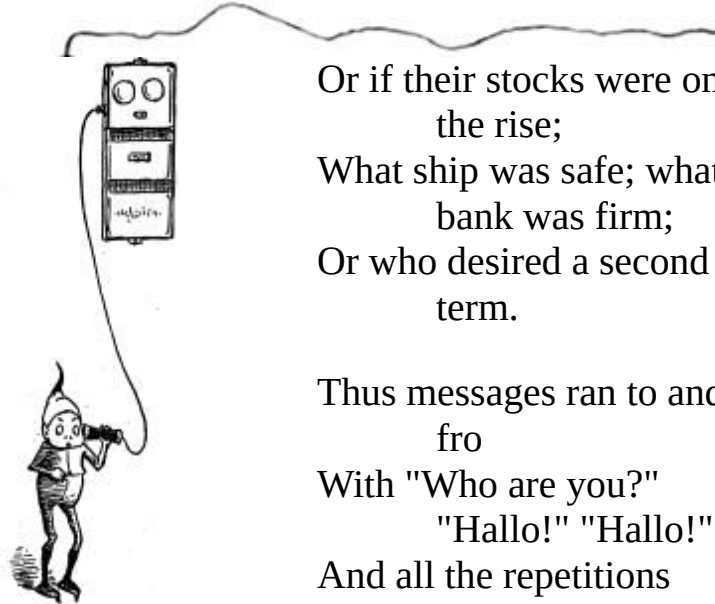
That

darks  
ome  
liquid  
may  
unfold  
!"



A telephone gave great delight

To those who tried it half the  
night,  
Some asking after fresh  
supplies;



Or if their stocks were on  
the rise;  
What ship was safe; what  
bank was firm;  
Or who desired a second  
term.

Thus messages ran to and  
fro  
With "Who are you?"  
"Hallo!" "Hallo!"  
And all the repetitions  
known  
To



those who use the  
telephone.

"Oh, here's the pen, as I  
opine,"  
Said one, "that's written  
every line;  
Indebted to this pen are  
we  
For all our fame and  
history."  
"See here," another said,

"I've found  
 The pointed pencil, long  
 and round,  
 That pictures all our  
 looks so wise,  
 Our smiles so broad  
 and staring  
 eyes;  
 'Tis well it draws us all  
 aright,  
 Or we might bear it off  
 to-night.  
 But glad are we to have  
 our name  
 In every region known  
 to fame,  
 To know that children  
 lisp our praise,  
 And on our faces love  
 to gaze."

Old



pistols that  
 brave service  
 knew

At Bunker Hill, were  
 brought to view  
 In mimic duels on the  
 floor,  
 And snapped at paces  
 three or four;  
 While from the foils  
 the Brownies  
 plied,

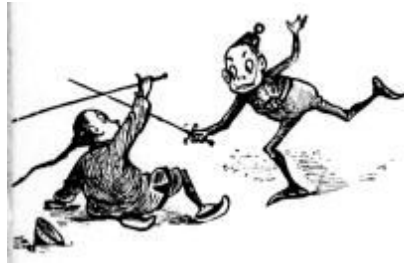


The sparks in showers  
scattered wide,  
As thrust and parry, cut  
and guard,

In



swift  
succession  
followed hard.



The British  
and  
Mong  
olian  
slash

Were tried in  
turn  
with  
brillia  
nt  
dash,

Till foils, and  
skill,  
and  
tempe  
r too,

Were amply  
tested  
throu  
gh  
and  
throu  
gh.

They found  
old

shield  
 s that  
 bore  
 the  
 dint  
 Of spears  
 and  
 arrow  
 -  
 heads  
 of  
 flint,  
 And held  
 them  
 up in  
 prope  
 r  
 pose;  
 Then rained  
 upon  
 them  
 Spart  
 an  
 blows  
 .



Lay figures, draped in  
 ancient styles,  
 From some drew  
 graceful bows  
 and smiles,  
 Until the laugh of

Until the laugh of  
 comrades nigh  
 Led them to look with  
 sharper eye.  
 A portrait now they  
 criticize,  
 Which every one could  
 recognize:



The features,  
 garments,  
 and the style,  
 Soon brought to  
 every face a



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